

LSR RESUMES OFFLINE CLASSES
AMID CAMPUS-WIDE OUTRAGE **P2**



LADAKH: SPARSE TURNOUT AT WANGCHUK
EVENTS AS L-G SAXENA TAKES COMMAND **P5**

'I DO WHAT THE
SCRIPT DEMANDS' **P14**



GANDHI CALLS 2024 LS POLLS 'COMPLETELY FAKE' CEC should resign, turn approver': Rahul steps up 'vote-chori' attack; BJP hits back

AAISHA SABIR/VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 24

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Thursday called for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, while reiterating his earlier claims of "vote-chori".

Mounting an all out attack, Gandhi said Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and CEC Kumar were "deshdrohis" (traitors) as they "destroyed" India's vote, and demanded that the CEC should immediately resign. The Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha advised CEC Kumar to turn "approver", while noting that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had done a good thing by accepting in a way that "vote chori" is happening.

Alleging that all elec-



tions are "rigged" and the 2024 Lok Sabha polls were "completely fake", Gandhi

asserted that Modi and Shah would be probed for what they have done to this coun-

try. He cited states like Haryana, Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, **CONTINUED ON P4**

'Resign in 48 hours or face protest': CJP warns CEC

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Thursday demanded Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation within 48 hours, alleging that the Special Intensive Revision

(SIR) of electoral rolls has undermined voters' rights. The youth-led outfit threatened a nationwide agitation followed by an indefinite sit-in at Delhi's Jantar Mantar.

Launching its "Election Commission Thik Karo" campaign, CJP founder **CONTINUED ON P4**

'ECINet decentralised, field officials retain statutory powers'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 24

The Election Commission's ECINet is a "decentralised" platform where statutory functions can

only be performed by the designated election officials and not by anyone at the poll body's headquarters, EC officials said on Thursday, citing official **CONTINUED ON P4**

No matter how much power we gain, we won't deviate from path of service: Modi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Dewas (MP), September 24

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said service would remain at the heart of the BJP's governance and values, regardless of the political power it attains. He said the government's focus should remain on nation-building and development rather than politics and elections.

Modi was interacting via video conference with participants of the 'Seva Sankalp Yatra', which is travelling from Vadnagar in Gujarat to Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh. The yatra, involving youth from several states, is being held to mark his 76th birthday and 25 years as an elected representative. The participants were in Madhya Pradesh's Dewas district.

"From Gujarat to Delhi, service has been the core of our governance system and values," Modi said, adding that the principle of "Nagrik Devo Bhava" should guide government policies. He



HIGHLIGHTS

- » He said development and nation-building should take precedence over politics and elections
- » Modi said young people will play a key role in making India a developed nation by 2047

urged the participants to demonstrate service through their actions and follow the principle of "Seva Parmo Dharma".

Modi said young people would play a key role in achieving the goal of a developed India by 2047. He also asked them to learn from traditional **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

SC Collegium recommends 12 judges

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court Collegium has approved the appointment of 12 additional judges as permanent judges in the high courts of Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Uttarakhand and Gauhati. The collegium, comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Vikram Nath and B V Nagarathna, took the decision at a meeting held on Wednesday. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Veteran actor Mushtaq Khan dies at 75

MUMBAI: Actor Mushtaq Khan, known for his character roles in over 500 films including hits such as "Welcome", "Gadar" and "Hum Hai Rahi Pyaar Ke", has died after a battle with cancer, son Mohsin said. The actor was 75. Khan was admitted to Nanavati hospital in suburban Mumbai about a fortnight ago. "He passed away due to cancer at Nanavati hospital at around 7pm. He had complained of stomach **CONTINUED ON P4**



Markets hit 3-month low

MUMBAI: Stock markets tumbled on Thursday with the benchmark index Sensex tanking nearly 1,248 points to settle at an over three-month low due to across-the-board selling, led by financials, metal, auto and oil shares amid a spike in crude oil prices and surging US bond yields. **SEE P12**

20 PEOPLE RESCUED

Nine killed as bus catches fire on Yamuna Expressway in UP

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, September 24

Nine passengers were killed after a bus travelling from Delhi to Mahoba caught fire on the Yamuna Expressway near Jewar late Wednesday night, with more than 20 people rescued from the vehicle, officials said on Thursday.

The bus, bearing registration number BR32PA8647, was carrying 35 passengers when the fire broke out near the 33-km milestone under the Jewar police station area at around 11.20 pm. The deceased included one woman and eight men, while the bodies have been sent to a mortuary for identification. Chief Fire Officer Pradeep Kumar said police and fire personnel, including four fire tenders and a rescue vehicle, reached the spot and brought the blaze under control. Nine people were found dead inside the bus, apparently due to burns or suffoca-



Firefighters at the site after a sleeper bus caught fire on the Yamuna Expressway in the Greater Noida area, killing nine passengers, in Noida

tion. One woman remains hospitalised, while several injured passengers were taken towards Mahoba for further treatment.

A preliminary investigation indicated that a spark or blast in the air-conditioning system may have caused engine lubricant oil to catch fire, allowing the flames to spread rapidly. Authorities said the exact cause is being investigated. However, an FIR filed

on a passenger's complaint alleges that travellers noticed a burning smell near the driver's cabin and warned the driver and conductor before the fire broke out. The complaint alleges that the warnings were ignored and that the bus was not stopped immediately. These allegations are part of the ongoing investigation. Passenger Rekha said smoke filled the bus after the **CONTINUED ON P4**

18-year-olds wait for voting rights as annual SSR on hold since 2024

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 24

The Election Commission of India's annual special summary revision (SSR) of electoral rolls for 2026-27 has been delayed amid differences among the three members of the poll panel, with the exercise missing its usual May-June announcement window, The Economic Times reported.

The SSR, conducted annually across states since 1958, is intended to update electoral rolls and add citizens who have turned 18. The exercise has not resumed in 2025-26 following the 2024 electoral cycle, even as Election Commissioners Sukhbir



THE ISSUE GAINED IMPORTANCE AFTER THE ELECTION COMMISSION BEGAN A SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION (SIR) IN BIHAR IN 2025

Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi are understood to have pushed for its return, according to the report.

The issue gained importance after the Election Commission began a Special Intensive Revision

(SIR) in Bihar in 2025. The Chief Election Commissioner is learnt to have sought a legal opinion on whether an SSR could be conducted while the SIR was underway. Following the advice, the two election commissioners maintained that the annual revision should resume in line with the ECI's electoral roll manual, ET reported.

The delay could affect the inclusion of new voters. Eligible citizens can now register based on four qualifying dates, January 1, April 1, July 1 and October 1. Earlier, January 1 was the only cut-off, meaning those born later in the year had to wait longer for registration. **CONTINUED ON P4**

ASIAN GAMES 2026

FIVE-MEDAL DAY GIVES INDIA A LIFT

WUSHU
Roshibina Devi won silver in the women's 60kg category, her second successive Asian Games silver and third overall medal.



SHOOTING
Parinaaz Dhatwal and Anantjeet Singh Naruka won bronze in the mixed team skeet event.



ATHLETICS
India's mixed 4x400m relay team of TS Manu, MR Poovamma, Vishal TK and Vithya Ramraj won silver, clocking 3:14.46.

ROWING
Satnam Singh and Salman Khan won bronze in the men's double sculls, finishing in 6:13.25.



FSSAI proposes ban on 'analogue paneer'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has proposed banning the manufacture and sale of non-dairy products being marketed as paneer, citing concerns over misleading consumers about their composition.

In a draft amendment to the Food Safety and Standards (Prohibition and Restrictions on Sales) Regulations, 2011, the regulator has proposed restrictions on products described as "paneer" **CONTINUED ON P4**

CRIMSON AND CAUTIOUS

LSR resumes offline classes amid campus-wide outrage

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 24

For the students of Lady Shri Ram College for Women (LSR), the leafy lanes leading to the campus back gate no longer offer a sense of familiar comfort. Instead, they serve as a daily reminder of a chilling reality that has shaken the university community to its core.

On Thursday, September 24, 2026, regular offline classes resumed on the campus, just a day after the administration briefly shifted to online teaching.

The momentary pause was triggered by an unspeakable tragedy: the alleged gang-rape of a 17-year-old girl at gunpoint inside Aastha Kunj Park, located barely two kilometers from the college and immediately adjacent to



a heavily frequented student route near the Kalkaji Temple.

A Community Shaken and Defiant

The incident, which occurred around dusk on Monday, September 21, has pierced the bubble of academic life in South Delhi. The victim, visiting the sprawling park with a

friend on her 17th birthday, fell prey to three men in an area that hundreds of LSR students traverse daily to reach the nearby metro station.

The college gates quickly became the epicenter of collective grief and fierce defiance. Hundreds of students staged a powerful solidarity march, their voices echoing through the



Mounted police conduct early morning patrols as staff interact with visitors in the Deer Park and Kamla Nehru Ridge areas

MPOST

South Delhi air.

Amidst the sea of protestors, Saavy, a student of Ram Lal Anand College and a member of AISA, captured the collective fury.

“The streets around LSR have been filled with a huge crowd chanting slogans of Azadi,” Saavy said. “Whether it is Bihar’s Jamui or Hathras, minors

are suffering from harassment and rape cases, and these cases are coming from right, left, and centre they aren’t stopping at all.

Near LSR, there are multiple safety issues, from broken streetlights to public gun violence. Neither the government nor the administration is taking this seriously. We demand accountability on

KEY POINTS

» ‘The streets around LSR have been filled with a huge crowd chanting slogans of Azadi,’ Saavy said

» ‘Near LSR, there are multiple safety issues, from broken streetlights to public gun violence. Neither the government nor the administration is taking this seriously. We demand accountability...’

shared. “It is because if our parents see us here, they will call us back home. We girls don’t even have the freedom to use our democratic right to protest against the government and raise our voices.”

Administrative Response and Wider Unrest

Recognising the psychological toll on the campus, Principal Kanika K Ahuja confirmed the return to physical classrooms while emphasising that student welfare remains paramount, noting that faculty mentors and counselors are available to offer support.

However, the shockwaves have galvanised student politics far beyond LSR.

On Thursday, the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Pari-

shad (ABVP) staged a protest outside the Vice-Chancellor’s office, linking the tragedy to rising threats across Delhi University.

ABVP and student leaders called for comprehensive security audits, regular police patrolling, and an overhaul of transit route security.

As LSR students return to their desks, the atmosphere remains resolute. The resumption of classes is not a return to normalcy, but a testament to their resilience and a stark warning that the fight for safety has only just begun.

Ultimately, the turbulent week serves as a stark reminder that true academic security requires systemic accountability, leaving students and authorities alike facing an urgent, unyielding demand for systemic reform.

FIR alleges driver ignored burning smell, refused to stop before blaze

Nine passengers killed after bus catches fire on Yamuna Expressway

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Noida, September 24

The driver and conductor of the bus that caught fire on the Yamuna Expressway in Greater Noida ignored a burning smell and refused to stop the vehicle despite repeated warnings from passengers, according to an FIR lodged based on a passenger’s complaint.

Passengers raised an alarm and asked the driver to stop the bus, but the driver and conductor allegedly refused, telling them, “If you want to die, then die; we won’t stop the bus,” according to the FIR.

Nine passengers were killed after a bus travelling from Delhi to Mahoba in



Uttar Pradesh caught fire late Wednesday night on the Yamuna Expressway in Greater Noida.

The FIR was registered at the Jewar police station on the complaint of Suneel Kumar, a resident of Hamirpur district, who said he boarded the Raj Kalpana Travels bus from Kashmir Gate in Delhi around 9 pm on Wednesday.

There were around 30-35 passengers on board, he said.

According to the complaint, the bus reached the 33-km mark on the Yamuna Expressway around 11.30 pm when passengers noticed a burning smell emanating from the driver’s cabin.

“Despite being alerted, the driver dismissed the

smell as something common in the bus and did not stop to inspect the vehicle,” he claimed.

“The driver and conductor continued smoking bidis and cigarettes in the cabin and that flames suddenly erupted near the driver’s seat shortly afterwards,” he further claimed.

Despite the passengers’ alarm, the driver and conductor allegedly told them that they won’t stop the bus.

Nine passengers died after a bus caught fire in Jewar, with the complaint alleging negligence by the driver and conductor. Both were detained as police investigated the incident.

“DRIVER DISMISSED THE SMELL AS SOMETHING COMMON IN THE BUS...”

Bus marshal killed as motorcycle hits her while crossing road

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

A 55-year-old Delhi Home Guard working as a DTC bus marshal was killed after a motorcycle allegedly hit her, and she subsequently came under a truck while crossing the road on Thursday near the Khajuri Flyover, officials said.

Police received information about the accident around 12:18 pm. A team from the Khajuri Khas police station in northeast Delhi reached the spot and identified the deceased as Sunita Thepliyal, a Bhajanpura resident.

Officials said bystanders had already taken the unconscious woman to JPC Hospital, where doctors

declared her brought dead. Police said they found a motorcycle and a truck at the spot.

According to a preliminary enquiry, the woman was crossing the road near the beginning of the Khajuri Flyover when the truck driver braked to avoid hitting her. The truck allegedly obstructed the motorcycle rider’s view, and he subsequently hit the woman. Police said she then fell in front of the truck and sustained fatal injuries. Police registered a case under relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at Khajuri Khas police station and arrested the truck driver and motorcycle rider.

Police said further investigation is underway.

Cab driver held for killing wife with metal rod

New Delhi, September 24

A 30-year-old cab driver was arrested for allegedly killing his 25-year-old wife with a metal rod after finding her with another man at their rented accommodation in Palam Vihar, Gurugram, police said.

The accused allegedly attacked the man before assaulting his wife. She was rushed to a hospital but declared dead. An FIR was registered.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

A Delhi court on Thursday sentenced five men to two years’ rigorous imprisonment for rioting and attacking police personnel during violence at a Bhajanpura petrol pump in the 2020 northeast Delhi riots.

Additional Sessions Judge Parveen Singh sentenced Arif, Mohd Khalid, Abdul Sattar, Tanveer Ali and Humain after convicting them of rioting, assault-

2020 DELHI RIOTS
Five get 2-year jail term for attacking cops

ing or obstructing public servants and using criminal force against police personnel.

The court awarded two years’ rigorous imprisonment to each convict under IPC Section 152, read with Section 149, for assaulting or obstructing public servants engaged in suppressing a riot. They were also sentenced to 1.5 years for rioting and assault or use of criminal force against public servants, and two months for

obstructing a public servant. All sentences will run concurrently.

The court said the unlawful mob and the assault and obstruction of policemen trying to suppress the riot were aggravating circumstances.

It said the case did not warrant a “very lenient view”, but maximum punishment was also not justified.

The court considered the convicts’ socioeconomic conditions, first-

offender status, their being sole breadwinners and the absence of subsequent criminal activity as mitigating circumstances.

The convicts were granted the benefit of time already spent in custody under Section 428 CrPC/Section 468 BNSS. The court had convicted them on September 9.

Their release will depend on the period already undergone and whether they are required in any other case.

Call centre duping US victims of around Rs 100 cr busted; 11 nabbed

New Delhi, September 24

The Delhi Police has busted an illegal international call centre in Pitampura that allegedly cheated US victims of around Rs 100 crore through a tech-support scam, arresting 11 people, officials said on Thursday.

The IFSO unit raided the premises on September 21 and seized Rs 41 lakh in cash, 29 laptops, 25 mobile phones, eight routers and an SUV.

Police said the syndicate allegedly installed malware on victims’ computers, directing them to a toll-free number. Call-centre agents then posed as technical-support staff, induced victims to grant remote access and claimed their bank accounts were at risk.

Fake bankers allegedly then persuaded them to buy gift cards or transfer cryptocurrency. The accused also allegedly sent forged communications purportedly issued by the FBI and other US federal agencies to intimidate victims.

MPOST



‘MEN ATTEMPTED TO PULL THEM INTO THE VEHICLE BUT FLED AFTER HER FRIEND STARTED RECORDING THE INCIDENT...’

HINDU COLLEGE STUDENT ALLEGES HARASSMENT NEAR PARK

Sexual violence cases expose gaps in security

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 24

A wave of alleged rape, gang rape and harassment cases reported across Delhi in recent days has renewed concerns over the safety of women and children in public spaces and highlighted the need for preventive measures, surveillance and awareness.

The incidents include the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl at Aastha Kunj Park near Kalkaji, the alleged rape of a minor at a hotel in Wazirabad, the harassment of two young women near Hakikat Park in Mukherjee Nagar, and the alleged

gang rape and murder of a 16-year-old girl in Swaroop Nagar. The cases are being investigated by the Delhi Police.

In the latest incident, a first-year Master’s student at Hindu College alleged that she and her friend were harassed by men travelling in a car near Hakikat Park around 9.30 pm on Wednesday.

She alleged that the men attempted to pull them into the vehicle but fled after her friend started recording the incident.

Police registered a case at Mukherjee Nagar police station and traced the vehicle owner. Questioning indicated that a man identified as Naman was driving the car.

In Wazirabad, a minor

who had befriended a man through social media allegedly told her family that he had raped her.

Police registered a case under relevant provisions of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act and other laws after recording her statement and conducting a medical examination. The accused remains at large.

The Aastha Kunj case has also highlighted security concerns in large public parks. Police have examined CCTV footage, technical evidence and forensic material, while the mobile phones of the three accused have been sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory. All three were arrested within hours of the incident.

Authorities have ordered a safety audit of Delhi’s parks, focusing on lighting, security, cleanliness and regular patrolling. Directions have also been issued to increase beat patrolling and deploy Pink Police personnel around parks.

MOVE FOLLOWS RECENT BUILDING COLLAPSES

DDA MOVE: Pre-2001 high-rises, hospitals, malls face safety audit

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has issued directions for a mandatory structural audit of all high-rise buildings, including malls, hospitals and educational buildings, which were constructed before 2001.

The move comes against the backdrop of building collapses, including the one in Satya Niketan, which claimed the lives of seven people.

“The structural safety audit is mandatory to be carried out by all the owners of all high rise buildings (15 metre or above) which were sanctioned before March 21, 2001. The structural audit is to be carried out within three months,” says a public notice issued on Thursday.

It also says that even if a building (sanctioned before March 21, 2001) is less than 15 metres in height but has high footfall, such as group housing, educational buildings, hospitals, and institutional buildings, the owners of such structures would also have to get the assessment done within three months.

According to officials, the notice has also been issued keeping in view the structural safety against



CLOSER LOOK

» **‘The structural safety audit is mandatory to be carried out by all the owners of all high rise buildings (15 metre or above) which were sanctioned before March 21, 2001. The structural audit is to be carried out within three months’**

» **It also says that even if a building (sanctioned before March 21, 2001) is less than 15 metres in height but has high footfall, such as group housing, educational buildings, hospitals, and institutional buildings, the owners of such structures would also have to get the assessment done within three months**

» **According to officials, the notice has also been issued keeping in view the structural safety against earthquakes**

earthquakes. Due to its proximity to the Himalayas, the national capital is located in Zone IV, which has fairly high seismicity where the general occurrence of earthquakes is of magnitude 5-6.

In the recent past, there have been building collapse incidents reported, which have claimed several lives

in the city. The structural integrity of these buildings has come under question.

After the audit, the DDA added, retrofitting and corrective measures will have to be carried out by the owners of the buildings.

In case of non-compliance, action will be taken against the owners, the order added.

CM inaugurates mega health check-up camp

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday inaugurated a mega health check up camp at Hairdarpur in her Shalimar Bagh constituency, and announced development of a new school and health centre in the area.

The health camp was held under the ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ being observed by the government.

During the programme, the chief minister also interacted with slum residents of the area and assured that not a single ‘jhuggi’ will be



CM embraces an elderly woman while inaugurating a free Mega Health Check-up Camp, in New Delhi

demolished in the area.

The government is working to provide better hous-

ing to people who have been living in difficult conditions for years, she said.

Govt to replace 20K old street lights before Diwali: Minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

By Diwali, Delhi government has targeted to replace 20,000 old street lights with smart LED lights, Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Thursday.

Under the smart street light project, the PWD has planned to change 96,000 old and dysfunctional lights and add 5,000 more street lights by January next year.

Lack of proper lighting in public roads has been part of the news recently after the gangrape of a 17-year-old girl in Astha Kunj Park near Kalkaji Temple after dark on Monday. Students from nearby Lady Shri Ram College (LSR) took out a solidarity march demanding better safety for women.

Three accused in the

case have been arrested and police and other agencies in Delhi have ordered improved facilities and safety measures.

“By Diwali we have a target to replace 20,000 old street lights with smart lights across the city. The biggest feature of the new system will be its centralised Command and Control Centre. Through this, every street light can be monitored in real time. Any malfunctioning light will be identified immediately and can also be controlled remotely,” Singh said.

As per the plan, all new lights will be real-time monitored through a control room setup at PWD headquarters.

The total estimated cost of the project is around Rs 473 crore, with five years of operation and maintenance and seven

year warranty on lighting fixtures.

According to officials, switching from old sodium lights to smart lights will also save the government around Rs 30 crore annually in electricity and maintenance cost.

The minister said many locations remained dark spots for long periods due to dysfunctional lights.

“Since there was no facility for real-time monitoring of street lights, information about faulty lights was received only after complaints were made,” he said.

“Under this framework, the private company installing the lights will receive monthly payments only after the lights are fully operational, ensuring that the company remains responsible for upkeep, performance and timely maintenance,” Singh said.



MCD reviews hospitals, directs improvements

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 24

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi on Thursday reviewed healthcare facilities and infrastructure at Hindu Rao Hospital and Rajan Babu Hospital, with senior civic officials directing improvements in patient amenities, cleanliness and hospital infrastructure.

At Hindu Rao Hospital, Mayor Pravesh Wahi inspected the OPD block, wards, Paediatric Emergency Block, ICU and Labour Room and interacted with patients about their treatment and the availability of medicines. He directed officials to ensure timely availability of essential medicines and improve cleanliness across the hospital.

The Mayor also reviewed ongoing infrastructure works, including the upgradation of the Labour Room and Paediatric Emergency Block. The ICU, which currently has eight beds, is being expanded to 18 beds.

The civic body is also planning to replace the hospital’s old and dilapidated Residence Block with a new Ward Block of

about 200 beds. A separate plan is being considered to relocate the Residence Block to the site of the existing Laundry Block after its removal.

During the inspection, Wahi directed officials to install LED lights in wards, repair broken benches and undertake repairs to roads within the hospital premises. He said the corporation would continue efforts to strengthen medical infrastructure and patient services.

At Rajan Babu Hospital, Leader of the House Jai Bhagwan Yadav inspected the bronchoscopy and ultrasound rooms, laboratory, kitchen, general ward and Kingsway Chest Centre. He interacted with patients and directed officials to improve cleanliness and clear garbage from isolated spots.

Yadav also instructed the maintenance and electrical departments to rectify loose and hanging wires and called for adequate ministerial staff to ensure smooth functioning of the hospital. He directed that trees on the premises be pruned and inspected food items and their expiry dates in the hospital kitchen.

‘Unmapped’, ‘mismatched’: SIR notices leave voters puzzled

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 24

Niranjan, an investment adviser from North West Delhi’s Rohini, is in limbo after receiving a notice under the ongoing Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls that challenged him as being “unmapped with last SIR” held in the city in 2002.

The 52-year-old man said that he was born and brought up in Delhi but had not been registered as a voter in the 2002 electoral roll, adding that he received the notice on September 18.

Niranjan, like a large number of other voters who have received similar notices, met the booth

level officer (BLO) and electoral registration officer of his constituency. “My BLO said the notice was system-generated and asked for my PAN card copy, assuring me that the error would be rectified,” he added.

The Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) has reiterated that receiving notice under SIR does not mean that the name of any voter will be automatically removed from the electoral rolls.

Notices were issued to over 33 lakh of the 97.5 lakh voters whose names were included in the draft rolls of Delhi published on August 31. The notices were issued broadly under two categories – ‘unmapped with last SIR’ held in 2002 in Delhi

and ‘logical discrepancies’ like name or age-related mismatches. A voter from the Laxmi Nagar constituency, who did not wish to be named, said he was unable to find the details of his parents in the 2002 SIR rolls.

“Although I was not eligible to become a voter around 2002, my parents were eligible voters and their names were added. But now, I am unable to find their details. “The problem has been aggravated further by the uncooperative behaviour of the BLO in our area,” he complained.

The voters, who have been issued notices, are required to furnish either their own details or those of their parents or grandpar-

ents in electoral rolls published after the SIR held in Delhi in 2002.

The notices issued by the poll officials will be disposed of by October 29. The final voters lists will be published on November 4. Those who have received notices under the ‘unmapped with last SIR’ category are required to furnish supporting documents to the electoral registration officer (EROs) and BLOs concerned.

Such voters who were born before July 1, 1987 need to submit their own date of birth or place of birth certificate. Those born between July 1, 1987 and December 2, 2004 are required to submit their own documents as well as

those of one of their parents. Further, those born after December 2, 2004 will need documents for themselves and both parents, poll officials said.

Any of various kinds of documents, including passport, birth certificate, matriculation certificate and caste certificate among others can also be submitted by the voters who have received notices for being ‘unmapped with last SIR’.

One document of the parent or parents will also be submitted as according to the date of birth category.

Special camps held for homeless, sex workers, trans persons

The Delhi poll body

held special camps for the homeless, transgender persons and sex workers across the national capital to facilitate their participation in the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls, officials said on Thursday. The two-day camps were held on September 23 and 24 from 5 pm to 9 pm at Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) night shelters and other locations where members of these communities were found, they said. The poll body has also deployed 605 additional assistant electoral registration officers across all Assembly constituencies for the disposal of notices and claims and objections, officials said.

‘ANGAN KA MILAN’



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta poses for group photographs with Anganwadi workers during the ‘Angan Ka Milan’ programme organised under the 9th National Nutrition Month and ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’, in New Delhi

PTI

DCPCR logs 377 complaints, including 38 POCSO cases

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

The Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights (DCPCR) has received a total of 377 complaints, including 38 cases under the POCSO Act, since its reconstitution in July till September, with the highest number of complaints about Right to Education (RTE), according to data released by the child rights body.

Out of the total complaints, 206 were related to RTE, followed by 87 concerning juvenile justice, 38 POCSO cases, 17 cases of missing children, 16 child labour cases, and 13 related to health and nutrition. The commission has also taken suo motu cognisance in 56 cases, it said on Thursday.

The North-West district recorded the highest number of complaints at 61, followed by North-East with 38, East 35, West 34, North 30, South-West and South 41 each, Central 25, South-East 24 and miscel-

laneous cases 22. In the wake of the alleged rape of a 17-year-old girl at Astha Kunj Park, the DCPCR has also issued a notice to the deputy commissioner of police concerned, seeking an action taken report within two weeks, said DCPCR chairperson Om Prakash Vyas.

During a press conference outlining the commission’s initiatives, Vyas announced that letters have been sent to the lieutenant governor, chief minister, and the MCD mayor/ commissioner, advocating for mandatory regular self-defence classes in schools across Delhi.

Vyas also mentioned that the commission is conducting a city-wide POCSO awareness campaign directed at children, parents, and school staff, focusing on safe and unsafe touch, reporting offences, and mental health counselling.

He said the commission’s child beggar-free Delhi ini-

tiative focuses on rescue, long-term care, emotional rehabilitation and mainstreaming of children into formal schools through coordination among different departments.

Under the initiative, the commission has created a mascot, jingles, logo and a slogan, ‘Bheekh nahi Seekh’, for its Child Beggar-Free Delhi campaign, which will be launched within a month, he said, adding that they also launched a child complaint helpline (9220999390) on Tuesday.

“As part of another new initiative, the department will also hire children who were in childcare centres and have attained the age of 18,” Vyas said.

The commission has also conducted field-level inspections of centralised kitchens, Anganwadi centres and food delivery systems as part of Rashtriya Poshan Maah to check the quality of nutrition being provided to infants and lactating mothers, he added.

L-G Sandhu inaugurates Sadbhavana Sammelan



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 24

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar TS Sandhu on Thursday inaugurated the Sadbhavana Sammelan at the historic Gandhi Ashram of the Harijan Sevak Sangh at Kingsway Camp, in the presence of National President of the Harijan Sevak Sangh Prof. (Dr.) Sankar Kumar Sanyal and other dignitaries and guests.

Recalling the history of the Harijan Sevak Sangh, Sandhu said it was founded in 1932 through the efforts of Mahatma Gandhi, when he was leading a nationwide movement against social discrimination. He said Gandhi’s idea of freedom and Swaraj meant that every individual should be treated with dignity and

rights. The L-G also recalled that several leading freedom fighters had visited the place to meet Gandhi and said the freedom struggle for political independence was accompanied by a parallel struggle for social unity, equality and brotherhood.

Sandhu recalled that Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya had presided over the historic Bombay meeting at which the Harijan Sevak Sangh was established, following the signing of the Poona Pact between Malaviya and Dr BR Ambedkar to address the concerns of the Depressed Classes. He said Gandhi, Malaviya and Babasaheb, in their different ways, worked towards ensuring that political freedom was accompanied by greater equality and dignity.

Briefs

DDA to host ‘Rang Ras Rooh’

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will host a two-day festival, ‘Rang Ras Rooh’, at Baansera near Birsai Munda Chowk, Sarai Kale Khan, on September 26 and 27 as part of World Tourism Day celebrations. A live qawwali performance by the Nizami Brothers on September 27 will be one of the major highlights of the festival.

Cong flags rabies vaccine lapses

NEW DELHI: Delhi Congress chief Devender Yadav on Thursday alleged that the seizure of spurious rabies vaccines in the Capital was an indication of serious lapses on the part of the Delhi government and agencies responsible for checking sale of counterfeit medicines.

Sessions court can't impose 'till rest of life' sentence for murder: Apex Court

The bench also said that the power to grant remission & commutation under the Code of Criminal Procedure cannot be curtailed by the sessions court

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

In a significant verdict, the Supreme Court on Thursday held that a sessions court, while convicting an accused for murder, cannot direct that the convict will remain in prison for the remainder of the natural life.

The verdict dealt with a vexatious legal question as to whether a trial court, while awarding the life imprisonment to a convict in a murder case under section 302 of the IPC, can hand down the sentence specifying that the convict will remain in jail for remainder of his life without the benefits of statutory regime of remission and commutation.

A bench comprising Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi, referring to verdicts, said, "Although life imprison-



ment denotes imprisonment for the remainder of the life of convict, the statutory powers of remission and commutation cannot be curtailed by a Sessions Court and thus, the power to impose a special category sentence of life imprisonment without remission belongs to the Constitutional Courts and not to the Sessions Court."

The bench also said that the power to grant remission and commutation under the Code of Criminal Procedure cannot be curtailed by the sessions court. It said that a direction by "the sessions court that imprisonment for life shall continue till the end of the natural life of the convict is in conflict with the statutory scheme".

Dealing with the facts of the case, the bench upheld the conviction of a man and another convict in a triple-murder case and substituted the sentence of imprisonment for remainder of life with rigorous imprisonment for 25 years without the benefit of statutory remission.

"We are of the view that there is no doubt that the Trial Court was competent to impose the punishment of imprisonment for life upon the appellants for the offence under Section 302 read with Section 34 IPC. However, at the same time, the Trial Court was not competent to impose a special category sentence that the appellants 'to remain in prison till rest of their life', which in substance and effect, excludes the statutory power of remission or commutation," the verdict said.

The judgment was delivered

in the criminal appeal filed by Naval Kishore and co-convict, arising from the killing of a woman and her two minor daughters in Ludhiana, Punjab in December 2009.

The case arose from the murder of Pinki alias Simran, her eight-year-old daughter Divya and five-year-old daughter Pooja at Ludhiana.

The trial court, by its 2014 judgment, convicted the accused and sentenced them to rigorous imprisonment for life and directed them "to remain in prison till rest of their life", besides imposing a fine of Rs 2,500 each.

The Punjab and Haryana High Court dismissed their appeal on December 12, 2022 and affirmed both the conviction and sentence. The top court also affirmed the conviction of the appellants under Section 302 of the IPC.

Bengal Power Shift: BJP & RSS leadership huddle in Delhi

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 24

The BJP's new political establishment in West Bengal came under the organisational lens of the RSS on Thursday, with the first high-level coordination meeting between the Sangh, the BJP's central leadership and the state's new political leadership being held at Ashoka Road here in New Delhi.

Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari, state BJP president Shamik Bhattacharya and Union Minister of State Sukanta Majumdar met BJP national general secretary (Organisation) BL Santosh and RSS Sah Sarkaryawah Arun Kumar at the meeting, which began at 7 pm.

The meeting marks the first major RSS-BJP coordination exercise after the BJP came to power in Bengal and brings the state's political and organisational leadership together with the BJP's central organisation and the Sangh leadership. Arun Kumar, a key link between the RSS and BJP, was present at the meeting. Though, the leadership



did not talk about the meeting's agenda, sources said that the discussions centred on the functioning of the new government, strengthening the BJP's organisational structure, coordination between the administration and grassroots workers, delivery of government programmes, ongoing social issues and the party's political programmes in the state.

The political significance of the meeting lies in the alignment of the three key layers of the BJP's Bengal establishment – the government led by Suvenudh, the state organisation headed by Shamik and the central leadership represented by Santosh, alongside the RSS.

For Suvenudh, the immediate task is governance; for Shamik, it is strengthen-

ing the party organisation after the Assembly elections. Majumdar's presence adds the Centre-state dimension to the exercise, bringing the Union government, state government and party organisation into one coordination framework.

The RSS-BJP coordination mechanism has also been used in other states to discuss government functioning and organisational matters. In Bengal, Thursday's meeting assumes added importance as the BJP begins its first phase of governance in a state where it has historically functioned as the principal Opposition force.

According to BJP sources, Shamik Bhattacharya will return to Kolkata with Suvenudh Adhikari on the Chief Minister's special aircraft after the meeting.

From page 1

CEC should

questioning how the anti-incumbency in these states had "disappeared."

Gandhi's address at a press conference at Indira Bhawan came after an investigative report from The Indian Express newspaper said that Election Commissioners Sandhu and Joshi recorded objections to decisions taken in the commission's name at least 14 times over 10 months. "... I have shown it with proof, and there is already more than enough information to make this a 100 per cent certainty that Indian elections, Lok Sabha elections, 2024 election, Vidhan Sabha elections are all being rigged," Gandhi said. The Congress MP further said that the two Election Commissioners had "done a wise thing", while adding that the CEC must "think seriously and turn approver".

The BJP hit back at Gandhi's latest allegations of "vote chori", rejecting his argument that the "disappearance" of anti-incumbency in several states is evidence of manipulation of elections and accused the Congress leader of lacking basic understanding of India's electoral history.

Snubbing Gandhi's "vote chori" charge, BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi questioned the Congress leader's claim that anti-incumbency had somehow disappeared in states where the BJP or its allies have repeatedly remained competitive.

"He has no knowledge of Indian politics. Congress has not been in power in Tamil Nadu since 1967. BJP didn't exist back then. In Bengal, there has been no Congress government since 1977. In Bihar, there has been no Congress government since 1990. In UP, Congress has not been in power since 1989. Since 1999, Congress has not been in power in Odisha. Rahul Gandhi has no knowledge of this... Ever since transparent elections have taken place, CCTV cameras have come in, and independent media has arrived, they've started finding it difficult to come to power," BJP's Rajya Sabha MP added.

Slamming Kumar, he said what the CEC has done is an act against the Indian nation.

"This is an attack on the Constitution and the legal structure of the country. You were supposed to ensure that the vote was protected. We have enough information to prove this with certainty. There are going to be consequences to this. We are not

going to let democracy be destroyed and sit silent. Those responsible will be punished," Gandhi said.

"The prime minister and Amit Shah are both going to be investigated for what has been done. Without any doubt, both the PM and Amit Shah, are at the top of this conspiracy and they are going to be investigated for what they have done to this country," Gandhi said and added that this is an act against the Indian state and its people.

"We refuse to sit silent while this happens. These are 'deshdrohis (traitors)'. A person who attacks the vote and fundamentally destroys India's democratic institutions is nothing other than a 'desh-drohi'," Gandhi said.

He also played out a few videos and asked people to listen to the tone of Modi and Shah. In the videos, Shah is heard saying the BJP will be in power for 30 years and the prime minister raising the slogan 'Abki Baar 400 Paar'.

No political leader who operates in a democratic environment can make such statements, Gandhi said. In India, there is a fundamental force called anti-incumbency which starts to resist and it does not spare anybody, he said.

"Indira Gandhi wins the Bangladesh War and within a year or two, massive pressure mounts due to anti-incumbency. It happens to leader after leader. It does not happen to Modi, Shah and the BJP - now we know the answer to it," Gandhi said.

Vote is the foundation of our democracy, Gandhi said, adding that the vote protected by the EC protects the Constitution. "If the vote has been destroyed then our Constitution has been destroyed, it no longer has the power. If the Constitution is destroyed laws are illegal and our institutions are meaningless," he said.

"Conspirators stole the vote, laws were stolen through vote theft, the country's institutions were stolen...Not only that - the laws made after the vote theft are illegal," Gandhi said.

Five Left parties also demanded removal of CEC Kumar and halt on Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, announcing week-long protests across the country from September 26 to October 2.

The announcement followed a meeting of CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby, CPI general secretary D Raja and CPI(ML)-Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya at A K Gopalan Bhawan here, after which the leaders addressed a press conference.

In a joint statement, the

CPI(M), CPI, CPI(ML)-Liberation, along with the Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and All India Forward Bloc (AIFB) demanded restoration of voting rights for those "wrongfully excluded" from electoral rolls and sought measures to restore the credibility and independent functioning of the Election Commission.

Dipankar Bhattacharya said the Left parties had three key demands -- "impeachment and prosecution of Gyanesh Kumar, immediate suspension of the SIR process, and restoration of voting right to all wrongfully-excluded voters".

CJP warns CEC

Abhijeet Dipke said more than 13 crore names had been excluded from draft electoral rolls across 30 states and Union Territories during the SIR exercise.

"If Gyanesh Kumar does not resign within 48 hours, we will start a nationwide protest," Dipke said, warning that "Jan-tar Mantar 2.0 will definitely happen".

The party cited exclusions of over 2 crore names each in Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, around 1 crore in Karnataka, 97 lakh in Tamil Nadu, 90 lakh in West Bengal, 73 lakh in Telangana, 47 lakh in Delhi and 24 lakh in Kerala.

CJP demanded an independent probe into SIR decisions, a halt to the exercise, restoration of earlier voter rolls and reforms in the appointment of election commissioners. It also sought publication of objections raised by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

ECINet

documents. The assertion comes amid questions over the functioning of the EC's digital systems following an Indian Express report that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had raised concerns over the "gradual centralisation" of the electoral roll database and the access available to officials in states.

The officials said booth-level officers (BLOs), assistant electoral registration officers (AEROs), electoral registration officers (EROs), district election officers (DEOs) and chief electoral officers (CEOs) perform their respective statutory functions on ECINet using unique IDs and passwords.

"No one else can perform their statutory function on ECINet, including any other officer of the ECI," an official said.

Cybersecurity for the plat-

form is, however, provided centrally by the EC. Officials said this was necessary to protect it from malicious attacks, citing around 68 lakh such attempts on counting day during the assembly elections earlier this year.

ERONET, the EC's earlier electoral roll management system, has now been integrated into the broader ECINet platform. Official documents refer to it as the "Electoral Roll module of ECINet Portal (previously ERONET)".

The issue has come into focus following reports that EROs in Goa found 97 voters eligible during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) but were unable to restore their names as the software did not provide a rollback option.

Separately, EC officials also rejected questions over the legality of an additional declaration sought from new voters along with Form 6 during the SIR.

Citing official documents, they said the declaration requirement was part of the June 24, 2025 Bihar SIR order and had the unanimous approval of the Commission.

The same provision was included in subsequent SIR orders covering 12 states and Union Territories in October 2025, and 19 states and UTs in May 2026, again with unanimous approval.

The officials maintained that Form 6 itself was not amended and that an additional declaration was sought along with it.

Modi

knowledge in villages and spread the message of "unity in diversity".

He referred to his seven-point 'Sapta Dhara' reform framework covering manufacturing, agriculture, technology, logistics, defence, the green and blue economy, and soft power.

Top Court

candidates from both factions have claimed the Trinamool identity in their nomination papers. Justice Joy-malya Bagchi observed that the notified election process could not now be disturbed.

Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Mamata Banerjee, argued that the ECI had acted only after keeping the dispute pending for months, leaving his client with little scope for judicial remedy once the election process began. He sought a direction for a decision in October, also citing forthcoming local body polls.

Counsel for Ritabrata Banerjee opposed such a short deadline, citing the need for

affidavits and evidence.

The court adjourned the matter to next week and asked the ECI to return with a proposed timeline.

BJP appoints

Sampark (Senior Worker Outreach) in Delhi.

At the state level, Ajay Jamal has been appointed State General Secretary (Organisation) for Maharashtra, while Satish Dhond will serve as State Joint General Secretary (Organisation) and handle Jan-jati Sampark in Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Maharashtra.

Madhukar has been appointed State General Secretary (Organisation) for Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, while Dashrath will serve as State Joint General Secretary (Organisation) for Telangana.

The restructuring also brings changes to the BJP's organisational setup in the eastern and northeastern states. Ravindra Raju has been appointed State General Secretary (Organisation) for Assam and Tripura, with office construction as an additional responsibility. Bhikubhai Dalsaniya will oversee Bihar, Pawan Sai Jharkhand, Manas Mohanty Odisha and Amitabh Chakraborty West Bengal. Dharampal has been appointed State General Secretary (Organisation) for Uttar Pradesh, while Chandrashekhar will oversee Madhya Pradesh and Karmveer Chhattisgarh.

For Gujarat and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, Ratnakar has been appointed State General Secretary (Organisation), while Arun Binnadi will serve as State Joint General Secretary (Organisation) for Gujarat.

The party has also appointed Phanindranath Sharma for Uttarakhand, Pawan Rana for Delhi and Haryana, Siddharthan for Himachal Pradesh, and Mantri Srinivasulu for Punjab and Chandigarh. In regional appointments, Abhay Giri has been appointed coordinator of the Braj Kshetra, with Agra as his base, while Ananta Narayan Mishra has been appointed coordinator of the Bhagalpur, Purnia and Kosi regions, with Purnia as his base.

The BJP said all the appointments would take effect immediately.

The organisational restructuring comes against the backdrop of the appointment of a new BJP national president and ahead of the organisational and electoral exercises the party is expected to undertake.

Nine killed

fire erupted near the driver's side and that people scrambled to escape. She said she managed to get out and fell onto the road.

The driver and conductor have been taken into custody, and an FIR has been registered at Jewar police station.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed grief over the incident. "Distressed to hear about the loss of lives due to a fire tragedy on a bus in Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh. Condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Praying for the swift recovery of the injured.

An ex-gratia of Rs. 2 lakh from PMNRF would be given to the next of kin of each deceased. The injured would be given Rs. 50,000" PM posted on X

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath also took cognisance of the incident and announced financial assistance of Rs 2 lakh each for the families of those killed. He also directed officials to ensure treatment of the injured and assistance to the affected families.

Mushtaq Khan

pain, so we took him to the hospital where doctors discovered that he has cancer. His health worsened in the last few days," his son Mohsin told PTI.

"He was perfectly fine, he had no major issues, rather he was shooting for the debut film of Shera's (Salman Khan's bodyguard) son prior to his hospitalization," he said.

In a career spanning five decades, Khan acted in over 500 movies and garnered wide popularity through his supporting roles. Some of his films like "Aashiqui", "Dil Hai Ki Manta Nahin", "Saathi", "Sadak", "Junoon", "Gunaah", "Sir", "Dil Hai Ki Manta Nahin", "Sadak", "Gadar", "Welcome", "Gadar 2", among others.

Khan's funeral will be held on Friday.

He is survived by his wife, son and a daughter.

18-year-olds

Under the normal schedule, the ECI announces the SSR by late May or early June. States then undertake two to three months of pre-revision work, followed by draft rolls between late August and early October. Claims and objections are generally invited for 30-45 days.

The delay is also significant for poll-bound states. Uttarakhand and Punjab are still undergoing SIR, while Uttar Pradesh and Goa have completed the process and are expected to undergo SSR

before their 2027 assembly elections. Bihar has also gone about a year without a roll revision.

The differences have had administrative consequences too. Annual confidential reports of nearly 50 officials transferred in 2025-26, including chief electoral officers and deputy election commissioners, remain pending because they require signatures from the CEC and both ECs, according to ET.

FSSAI

when they are made from constituents not derived from milk. Stakeholders have been given 60 days to submit objections or suggestions.

Products already licensed under the "Analogue in Dairy Context" category would have to remove the term "paneer" from their nomenclature, labels and marketing.

The Health Ministry said the move would ensure product names accurately reflect their nature and composition. Several states have already banned analogue paneer.

The proposal comes amid increased enforcement by FSSAI against misleading claims, labelling violations and hygiene-related breaches, including recent action against major e-commerce platforms.

SC Collegium

Five additional judges have been approved for permanent appointment to the Andhra Pradesh High Court.

"The Supreme Court collegium, in its meeting held on September 23, has approved the proposals for appointment of the following Additional Judges as Permanent Judges of the High Court of Andhra Pradesh: (i) Shri Justice Maheswara Rao Kuncham @ Kuncham, (ii) Shri Justice Thoota Chandra Dhara Sekar @ T.C.D. Sekhar, (iii) Shri Justice Challa Gunaranjan, (iv) Shri Justice Avadhanam Hari Haranadha Sarma, and (v) Dr. Justice Yadavalli Lakshmana Rao," a statement said.

For the Kerala High Court, the Collegium approved the appointment of Justices P Krishna Kumar, KV Jayakumar, Muralee Krishna S, Jobin Sebastian and PV Balakrishnan as permanent judges.

The collegium also approved the appointment of Justice Subhash Upadhyay, an additional judge, as a permanent judge of the Uttarakhand High Court.

In another resolution, it approved the appointment of Justice Kaushik Goswami, an additional judge, as a permanent judge of the Gauhati High Court.

MODI CABINET’S ‘CHINTAN SHIVIR’

Ministers discuss improving delivery of welfare schemes

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

The ‘Chintan Shivir’ of the entire council of ministers of the Narendra Modi government on Thursday discussed threadbare how to ensure 100 per cent penetration of all government schemes to the actual beneficiaries and connect with citizens effectively on the steps taken for their welfare.

For the second consecutive day, the ministers were divided into eight groups, and Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacted with each of them, besides addressing them together, sources aware of the deliberations said.

While there are 40-45 government welfare schemes, the focus of the meeting was on how to ensure 100 per cent penetration of all of them to the actual beneficiaries.

The ‘Chintan Shivir’ also discussed how to connect with citizens effectively on the welfare schemes and other development measures taken for their welfare.

Effective communication to the people is one area where the government will place stress in the coming days, the sources said.

The first day of the conclave of the ministers on Wednesday discussed a host of issues, including governance, reforms and outreach to women and youth on welfare and



PM Narendra Modi receives standing ovation from the Union ministers during a Cabinet meeting, in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The focus of the meeting was on how to ensure 100% penetration of all government schemes to the actual beneficiaries
- » They also discussed how to connect with citizens effectively on the welfare schemes and other development measures taken for their welfare

development schemes, the sources said.

During the two-day meeting, the ministers also discussed how to further improve the delivery mechanism of the government with close coordination among different ministries and departments, the sources said.

The prime minister is learnt to have taken feedback from the ministers and advised them on how to go about various aspects of the government.

The ministers discussed issues related to governance, reforms and outreach to women and youth on welfare and develop-

ment schemes, they said.

The other issues that were deliberated by the ministers included ‘Jan Vishwas Se Jan Aadhaar’, reforms in all aspects of the government and priorities towards Viksit Bharat@2047.

The two-day brainstorming session has been called for stocktaking, improving coordination, preparing the future agenda, planning, reviewing the work underway on welfare schemes, and infrastructure projects, among others.

The Viksit Bharat exercise has been underway since 2021, with 10 sectoral

groups of secretaries constituted to prepare short-term and long-term roadmaps to achieve the goal.

Vast stakeholder consultation was also done for this exercise.

Since then, there have been eight presentations and discussions before the council of ministers on different aspects of Viksit Bharat@2047.

The ongoing ‘Chintan Shivir’ takes this process forward, the sources said.

It brings together the work being done by groups of secretaries, ministries and departments, Cabinet Secretariat and NITI Aayog, including reforms, ease of living, reduction of compliances and other governance priorities.

Progress of government schemes, policy implementation, time management, inter-ministerial coordination and public service delivery are issues that figure in the agenda of the conclave.

Congress Working Committee to meet on Sept 29; SIR row on agenda
CWC likely to also deliberate upon poll preparations

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

The Congress Working Committee will meet on September 29 to discuss the party’s roadmap for upping the ante against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the government in light of reports of differences within the Election Commission over SIR, sources said.

The meeting, chaired by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, is likely to be attended by former party chief Rahul Gandhi, Congress general secretaries Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Jairam Ramesh, KC Venugopal, among others.

Sources said the party’s highest decision-making body will strategise on ramping up pressure over its demand for Kumar’s removal and cornering the government over the issue.

They said preparations for the upcoming polls are



THE PARTY WOULD CHART A ROADMAP FOR UPPING THE ANTE AGAINST CEC KUMAR

also likely to be deliberated upon.

The Congress on Thursday alleged that Gen Z is being targeted for exclusion and pressed for its demand that Kumar must resign immediately.

The opposition party also said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah will be held accountable for their “diabolical designs”.

The Congress’ attack comes a day after an Indian Express report said that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions and orders they said were issued without their

knowledge, even as the national rollout of the SIR was under the supervision of the full commission.

Their objections covered the manner in which the statutory voter registration Form 6 was amended, the handling of additions and deletions from voter lists, and centralised control over the electoral roll database, according to the report

Under fire over the red flags raised by two of its commissioners over the SIR process, the EC asserted on Wednesday that differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberations in any institution and all its orders carry full legal sanction and follow established statutory procedures.

J’khand Min’s daughter among 4 killed as car rams into truck

MPOST BUREAU
Jamshedpur, September 24

Jharkhand minister Dipika Pandey Singh’s daughter Trisha was among four people killed when their car ramed into a stationary truck on Marine Drive Road in Jamshedpur early Thursday, police said.

The other victims were identified as Sarthak Agarwal, Naman Gupta and Vanshika Khandelwal. All four occupants died on the spot, police said.

The truck was parked near the divider after apparently breaking down, with no reflector or warning signage visible, officials said. The car was badly mangled in the collision.

Trisha’s mortal remains were brought to Ranchi after post-mortem at MGM Hospital in Jamshedpur. Chief Minister Hemant Soren and several political leaders offered condolences.

MARKING MODI’S 25 YEARS IN PUBLIC LIFE

BJP launches ‘Seva First Innovation Challenge’

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 24

The BJP has launched a Seva First Innovation Challenge (SFIC) as part of its month-long nationwide Seva Sankalp Abhiyan to commemorate Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years in public life.

The SFIC is being rolled out across the country to provide young Indians an

opportunity to identify problems in their villages, towns and communities and develop innovative and practical solutions to address them, according to the party.

The Seva Sankalp Abhiyan was launched on Modi’s birthday on September 17 with a series of programmes focused on youth outreach and public participation.

“Twenty-five years of

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi as head of government – first as chief minister of Gujarat and subsequently as prime minister of India – have been marked by countless achievements.

“Among the most important have been the prime minister’s commitment to creating a better future for India’s youth, his trust in their potential, and his belief that innovation can

provide solutions to people’s problems,” said Kerala BJP president Rajeev Chandrasekhar, who is also the in-charge of SFIC.

Under the initiative, young people will be encouraged to identify problems and build solutions aimed at serving their respective states and the nation. Their efforts will be rewarded with prizes and investment opportunities.

UP: Akhilesh begins ‘PDA’ chariot yatra

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Rae Bareli, September 24

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Thursday launched his campaign for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections with a PDA chariot yatra in Rae Bareli, drawing a large number of party workers and supporters onto the streets.

Yadav, who travelled on the specially decorated chariot, was welcomed by party workers at several places along the route. The yatra is being projected by the SP as a mobilisation drive around its PDA plank, which the party defines as the representation of backward classes, Dalits and minorities.

Before setting out, Yadav posted on social media: “The ‘PDA Chariot’ sets forth. The voice of ‘PDA’ joins in. Now, a ‘change’ is about to happen. UP will once again be prosperous.”

The campaign comes as political parties begin stepping up preparations for the 2027 Assembly elections.

Ladakh: Sparse turnout at Wangchuk events as L-G Saxena takes command

MPOST BUREAU
Leh, September 24

Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk’s efforts to mobilise public support in Leh around the first anniversary of last year’s violence received a muted response, with the padyatra and public meeting witnessing limited participation, even as the Ladakh administration under Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena maintained a firm grip over the situation.

According to sources, no more than 70 people participated in the padyatra led by Wangchuk on September 23, despite permission having been sought for a 20-km foot march from Kharu village to Leh Market. “The march was terminated after covering only about four km at Stakna. The participants then boarded vehicles and proceeded to Sindhu Ghat before marching to the NDS Memorial Park,” they said.

The poor turnout was followed by another subdued response to the inter-faith prayer meeting organised by the Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA) at the NDS ground on Thursday. Permission was granted for the meeting from 10 am to noon, and organisers were expecting a crowd of 10,000 people to attend it. However, fewer than 800 people attended, with the gathering numbering just over 120 during its first hour.

The meeting was addressed by Wangchuk,



‘ORGANISERS WERE EXPECTING A CROWD OF 10,000 PEOPLE TO JOIN THE PROGRAMME. HOWEVER, FEWER THAN 800 PEOPLE ATTENDED’

LBA president Chering Dorjay Lakrook, Ladakh MP Mohammed Hanifa Jan, Thupstan Chhewang, Asghar Karbalai and Sajjad Kargili, among others.

The muted response to the two programmes contrasts with the scale of mobilisation projected by the organisers. The developments also came as the administration sought to project a message of reconciliation ahead of the anniversary of the September 24, 2025 violence.

On Wednesday, Saxena approved withdrawal of criminal cases against 20 people booked in connection with last year’s violence, saying the decision was taken in the larger interest of peace, public tranquillity and social harmony.

Ladakh Police had recommended a closure report after reviewing the cases.

Wangchuk, meanwhile, has continued to demand the early publication of the judicial inquiry report into last year’s violence and adequate compensation for the victims. He has also pressed for safeguards for Ladakh, including statehood and Sixth Schedule-related demands. Meanwhile, the Ladakh Police rejected allegations made during Thursday’s meeting that barricades were erected to prevent people from attending it. The police said the security and traffic arrangements were put in place because organisers had projected a large gathering, and maintained that no individual was stopped from reaching the venue.

The administration said the arrangements were intended to ensure public safety and the smooth conduct of the programmes, while the limited participation in Wangchuk’s events provided a markedly different picture from the large mobilisation anticipated by the organisers.

ONE STAGE

COUNTLESS COLOURS OF

UTTAR PRADESH

CRAFT. CUISINE. CULTURE. CREATIVITY.

A Global Hub for Trade, Commerce, Investment & Innovation with 6 Partner Countries and Participation from 88 Countries

Inauguration of

2,400+ Exhibitors

1,50,000+ B2B Visitors

UP INTERNATIONAL TRADE SHOW

25TH-29TH SEPTEMBER, 2026
4TH EDITION
INDIA EXPO CENTRE & MART, GREATER NOIDA

4,50,000+ B2C Visitors

1,10,000+ Sqm. Gross Area

JAPAN

RUSSIA

SINGAPORE

VIETNAM

AUSTRIA

BELARUS

Amit Shah

Minister, Home Affairs and Cooperation, Government of India

Yogi Adityanath

Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

In the august presence of

Brajesh Pathak

Deputy Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

Nand Gopal Gupta 'Nandi'

Minister, Industrial Development, Export Promotion, NRI & Investment Promotion, Uttar Pradesh

Bhupendra Chaudhary

Minister, Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Uttar Pradesh

Brajesh Singh

Minister of State, Public Works Department, Uttar Pradesh

Hans Raj Vishwakarma

Minister of State, Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Uttar Pradesh

Surendra Singh Nagar

Member, Rajya Sabha

Dr. Mahesh Sharma

MP, Gautam Buddha Nagar

Amit Chaudhary

Administrator, District Panchayat, Gautam Buddha Nagar

Shrichand Sharma

MLC

Narendra Singh Bhati

MLC

Pankaj Singh

MLA, Noida

Tejpal Singh Nagar

MLA, Dadri

Dhirendra Singh

MLA, Jewar

and other dignitaries

Date: 25th September, 2026 | Time: 11:00 AM | Venue: India Expo Centre & Mart, Greater Noida

Business Hours: 11:00 AM-3:00 PM | Visiting Hours: 3:00 PM-8:00 PM

Key Highlights

Global Marketplace for Trade, Investment & Innovation

Knowledge Sessions - Collaboration, innovation & global knowledge exchange | **Business Platform** - Connecting exhibitors, entrepreneurs and exporters across sectors including IT & Electronics, EV, Agriculture, ODDP, ODDC, Startups, Education, Food Processing, Health & Family Welfare, AYUSH, Tourism, Textiles and Leather | **Exhibition** - Showcasing UP's products, enterprises, and emerging brands to a global audience | **Global Recognition** - Celebrating MSMEs, exporters & traditional artisans | **UP Heritage** - Crafts, cuisine, textiles & cultural richness | **Cultural Performances** - Folk traditions, talent & creativity | **Awards** - Honouring excellence, innovation and outstanding contributions

Be Part of UP's Global Journey

Chief Minister Helpline
1076

Information and Public Relations Department, U.P.
Live Telecast | DD NEWS & YouTube.com/DDNEWS

Vikas Ki Gati Apaar
Double Engine Sarkar

DAYS AFTER JAMUI INCIDENT

Molestation cases reported from two more Bihar districts

MPOST BUREAU Patna, September 24

Days after the horrific molestation case in Bihar's Jamui district, a girl was allegedly harassed in public by a group of people in Samastipur and a minor was "sexually assaulted" in Muzaffarpur, prompting the Opposition to target the BJP-led NDA government over the law and order situation.

The fresh incidents led to the arrest of altogether five persons, police said on Thursday.

In Samastipur, the police arrested four persons who have been booked under relevant sections of the BNS, besides the IT Act and POCSO Act, after a video went viral on social media in which they could be seen molesting the girl.

According to a statement issued by Samastipur police, the video "appears about a week old" and the victim was "yet to be identified", though a case was lodged under the aforementioned laws since "the girl looked like a minor and the matter was sensitive".

Three of the accused, Vikas Kumar, Rahul Kumar and Rambabu Sahni, were residents of Jagatsinghpur village, where the incident had taken place, while the fourth, Awadhesh Paswan, hailed from Bijaulia.

In adjoining Muzaffarpur, police arrested



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

one Lalit Kumar who had allegedly molested and beaten up a girl in the Town police station area.

According to the Muzaffarpur police, the accused appeared to be mentally unstable, and his condition was being investigated by experts while the victim has been admitted to the Sadar Hospital for treatment.

Police also debunked rumours on social media that a similar incident had taken place in Madhepura.

According to the Madhepura police, a video that was being circulated was shot near a secondary school, and the students, male and female, were engaged in a heated debate after half-yearly examinations.

The Madhepura police also said it will take action against "those who shared the video on social media with ulterior motives".

Meanwhile, the fresh incidents led to fresh

attacks on the state's BJP-led government from opposition leaders like RJD working president Tejashwi Yadav and Jan Suraj Party founder Prashant Kishor.

Yadav, who is the leader of the opposition in the state assembly, linked the worsening law and order with alleged criminal antecedents of Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary.

He also shared a video of minister Ashok Choudhary, claiming that the outbursts of the senior JD(U) leader were "a clear signal of administrative chaos that engulfs Bihar".

Ashok Choudhary, whose daughter Shambhavi is, incidentally, the LJP(RV) MP from Samastipur, can be heard saying the incidents in Bihar should not be fretted about as crimes against women took place "in highly advanced countries like America and Japan".

Kishor responded to

HIGHLIGHTS

- » A minor was allegedly 'sexually assaulted' in Muzaffarpur
- » Girl was allegedly harassed in public by a group of people in Samastipur
- » The fresh incidents led to the arrest of altogether five persons

the latest incidents during a whistle-stop tour of Samastipur.

"Such an incident has taken place here and in Muzaffarpur. Earlier it was Jamui. Not a day passes without crimes being committed in some part of Bihar. Only yesterday, a former corporator was shot at in Patna", said the Bankipur MLA.

He claimed, "The point is that we cannot expect better administration until there is a change in the government's very character. An uneducated and criminal is the chief minister."

Effective control over the police has gone into the hands of the mafia involved in land, liquor and sand deals, Kishor alleged.

"No wonder that those arrested in connection with the Jamui molestation case happen to be closely associated with local gangs involved in illegal sand mining," he added.

IIT Bombay student's 'suicide' case: Parents start hunger strike in Mumbai

Institute defers its mid-semester examinations amid ongoing controversy

MPOST BUREAU Mumbai, September 24

The parents of IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode, whose death has triggered allegations of caste discrimination, began a hunger strike in Mumbai on Thursday seeking action against those they hold responsible for allegedly tormenting their son, as the institute postponed mid-semester examinations and apologised again over its earlier communication on his death.

Sahil's parents, Ravindra and Sonali Wakode, began the protest at Azad Maidan. Ravindra said his son had repeatedly told the family about alleged caste discrimination at the institute and demanded that those responsible be arrested.



Police personnel detain activists into a bus as they protest outside the IIT Bombay

PTI

The couple also met the chairman of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes and submitted a memorandum seeking a speedy investigation.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi spoke to the parents and assured them support in their pursuit of justice, party sources said.

Congress MP Varsha Gaiwad said Gandhi spoke to the family for nearly 17 minutes through a video call.

IIT Bombay postponed its September 26-27 mid-semester examinations to October 10-11. The institute also reissued an apology for its earlier statement

NBEMS declares NEET-PG 2026 results

MPOST BUREAU New Delhi, September 24

The National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) on Thursday declared the results of NEET-PG 2026. The minimum qualifying cut-off for General and EWS candidates is 262 marks, corresponding to the 50th percentile.

For General PwBD candidates, the cut-off is 244 marks (45th percentile), while for SC, ST and OBC candidates, including PwBD candidates from these categories, the cut-off is 226 marks (40th

percentile).

The final merit list and category-wise merit lists for state quota seats will be prepared by the respective states and Union Territories as per their eligibility criteria, applicable guidelines and reservation policies, the NBEMS said.

The individual scorecards of candidates will be available for download from the NBEMS website from October 1. The scorecards will remain available for download for six months from the date of issue, it said.

According to the

NBEMS notice, the NEET-PG 2026 rank has been arrived at based on the actual marks scored by candidates and the applicable tie-breaking criteria. The board said each question asked in both NEET-PG 2026 question papers was reviewed by faculty members from the concerned speciality areas after the examination to re-check the technical correctness of the questions and answer keys.

"None of the questions have been found to be technically incorrect," the notice said.

ED conducts searches at 26 locations

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 24

The Enforcement Directorate on Thursday searched and surveyed 26 premises across Delhi, Mohali, Chandigarh, Panchkula and Ludhiana in a money laundering probe linked to Tirupati Infra Projects Pvt Ltd and associated entities.

The action followed a CBI FIR alleging a Rs 238-crore bank fraud involving Tirupati Infra Projects. The ED said its preliminary probe also found alleged cash dealings, bogus share premiums and other financial irregularities.

The agency said its investigation indicated wider irregularities in the Greater Mohali Area Development Authority, including waiver of statutory dues, re-allotment of cancelled plots, land acquisition and auctions. It alleged benefits of around Rs 57 crore were extended through waiver of statutory dues.

Mahadev betting app 'kingpin' held

NARESH BISWANI New Delhi, September 24

The CBI has arrested Abhishek Kumar, an alleged kingpin and wanted accused in the Mahadev Online Betting App case, after he arrived from Dubai at Rajiv Gandhi International Airport in Hyderabad, the agency said on Thursday.

According to the CBI, its investigation has found that Kumar was allegedly involved in operating betting and gambling services through Mahadev Book, arranging betting panels, raising funds and purchasing immovable properties in Dubai with proceeds from the illegal activities.

The agency said incriminating material recovered from Kumar indicated his alleged links with the betting network and other key accused, including Saurabh Chandrakar and Shubham Soni.

Kumar was first produced before a court in Hyderabad, which granted the CBI three-day transit remand. He was subsequently taken to Raipur and produced before the competent court, which granted him two-day police custody.

The Chhattisgarh government had transferred 13 FIRs registered at various police stations in the state in connection with the case to the CBI, which took over their investigation.

The agency has so far filed eight chargesheets naming 100 accused, including alleged promoters of the betting application, betting panel operators, hawala operators and public servants.

Briefs

'Serial fraudster' arrested

PUNE: CISF personnel arrested a suspected serial fraudster at Pune Airport on Thursday for allegedly cheating an arriving passenger of Rs 11,000 using a fake identity. Officials said CCTV footage linked him to a similar Rs 18,600 cheating case on September 1. He was handed over to Vimalant Police Station for further action.

MP: 2 boys drown in quarry pit

MORENA: Two boys aged 15 and 16 drowned after entering a water-filled quarry pit for a swim in Morena district on Thursday, police said. Vikas Adivasi and Sunil Adivasi had gone cycling before entering the pit near Kars Dev Baba temple. Their bodies were recovered and sent for post-mortem. Police registered a case.

UP: 3 held with Rs 2-cr heroin

GHAZIPUR: Three people, including a woman, were arrested on Thursday after 1.15 kg of heroin allegedly worth over Rs 2 crore was recovered from their SUV, police said. ANTF and city police intercepted the vehicle on the Gorakhpur-Varanasi highway in Maharajganj following a tip-off about narcotics being transported.

Nayab Saini launches 'Satarak-Haryana' app

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 24

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday launched the 'Satarak-Haryana' mobile app to enable citizens to directly report corruption-related complaints and information to the State Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (SV&ACB).

Launched at the Haryana Secretariat, the app allows users to connect with the Bureau's helpline, upload digital evidence such as videos, audio and photographs, and share information confidentially even when they do not seek immediate action against a particular person.

The app covers all 23 districts and provides users with the name and mobile number of the concerned SV&ACB officer, office location and directions through Google location services. Citizens can also access senior officers, including the concerned Superintendent of Police,



in case of complaints against Bureau personnel.

Saini said citizens can also download copies of FIRs made available through the app in accordance with applicable rules.

The Chief Minister said information shared through the platform would help create a systematic digital database on corruption that could be analysed and utilised as required under rules.

SV&ACB Chief Arshinder Singh Chawla urged citizens to upload only genuine and fact-based information. He cautioned against submitting false, misleading or artificially created material, including AI-generated content, saying action could be taken under applicable rules.

CM announces Rs 750-cr initiative for SC-dominated Punjab villages

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 24

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Thursday announced a programme involving more than ₹750 crore for the holistic development of 3,763 villages where the Scheduled Caste population exceeds 40 per cent.

Chairing a review meeting of the Social Justice, Empowerment and Minorities Department, Mann said the initiative would promote social justice and balanced rural development by addressing the specific needs of deprived villages.

"Every village deserves equal opportunities for growth and development must reach those sections and areas which have remained deprived for decades," Mann said. He said the Social Justice, Empowerment and Minorities Department would serve as the nodal department, with the Rural Development and Horticulture

Punjab CM approves recruitment of 450 ASIs

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, September 24

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Thursday approved the direct recruitment of 450 assistant sub-inspectors (ASIs).

While chairing a meeting to review the functioning of the Home Department, Mann said the recruitment will provide educated youth an opportunity to join the police department through a transparent and

merit-based selection process, besides augmenting manpower for more effective policing and tackling emerging law-and-order challenges across the state.

According to an official statement, Mann stated, "An efficient, responsive and adequately staffed police force is essential for maintaining law and order, combating crime and ensuring the safety and security of the people."

Departments providing support.

Deputy Commissioners will identify and prioritise development works based on the requirements of individual villages. Mann said ₹20 lakh would initially be provided to each village as untied funds, with additional allocation possible after assessment

and proper utilisation.

A Specific Village Development Plan will be prepared for every village to ensure need-based and coordinated development. The funds can be used for facilities including RO systems, additional classrooms, libraries, ambulances, Mohalla Clinics and solar street lights.

3RD CONFERENCE OF ANTF HEADS

From seizures to networks: India sharpens its anti-drug strategy

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 24

The third National Conference of Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) Heads of States and Union Territories concluded here on Wednesday, with participants reiterating their commitment to implementing the Vision Document on Narcotics Control 2026-29.

The two-day conference, organised by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) under the theme 'United Resolve, Shared Responsibility', witnessed the participation of ANTF heads from 28 states and 8 UTs and officials from various government depart-



Union Home minister addresses the opening ceremony of the third ANTF conference

ments. The Union Home Minister Amit Shah had inaugurated the conference on September 22.

The conference deliberated on institutional mech-

anisms, demand reduction and rehabilitation besides steps to dismantle drug trafficking networks and cartels. There was emphasis on moving away from sei-

KEY POINTS

- » The two-day conference, organised by the NCB under the theme 'United Resolve, Shared Responsibility', witnessed the participation of ANTF heads from 28 states and 8 UTs
- » The Union Home Minister Amit Shah had inaugurated the conference on September 22
- » The conference deliberated on institutional mechanisms, demand reduction and rehabilitation besides steps to dismantle drug trafficking networks and cartels

zure-centric to network-centric strategy with a focus on financial profiling, intelligence-led investigations and targeting of organised trafficking networks and kingpins.

The conference also

deliberated on strengthening State ANTFs, improving coordination through NCORD and Joint Coordination Committee meetings and effective implementation of PITNDPS Act. The participants discussed

UGC's Nasha Mukta Campus Framework, creation of 500-metre drug-free zones around educational institutions and expansion of the Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyan.

The second day of the conference was devoted to international cooperation including coordination with Interpol and foreign agencies, deportation of fugitives and role of Financial Intelligence Unit-India in financial investigations. The use of digital platforms like NIDAAN, e-Sakshya, e-Prison and CCTNS besides Nar-K9 and the MAC platform were also discussed.

Emerging threats of synthetic drugs, precur-

sor chemicals, clandestine laboratories, darknet and cryptocurrency were also examined. The voluntary code of conduct for the chemical industry to prevent diversion of precursor chemicals was also discussed.

In his valedictory address, NCB Director General urged the states to work out three-year, state-specific roadmaps aligned with the national vision document and emphasised on enhancing intelligence-sharing and coordination among agencies to detect and dismantle transnational, interstate and intra-state drug networks.

EDITORIAL

Building Cities That Endure

The Supreme Court’s observations on Gurugram’s recurring civic breakdown raise a question that goes far beyond one city: how much construction can urban India accommodate without first strengthening the infrastructure needed to sustain it? While hearing a challenge concerning Karnataka’s Premium Floor Area Ratio scheme, the court pointed to Gurugram as an example of what happens when urban growth races ahead of planning. The concern is timely. Indian cities are expanding rapidly, but roads, drains, sewerage, water supply and public transport frequently remain designed for populations and densities of another era.

Gurugram illustrates this contradiction dramatically. It houses multinational corporations, expensive residential towers, shopping centres and some of India’s most valuable commercial real estate. Yet heavy rain can bring parts of this global business hub to a standstill. Waterlogged roads, submerged underpasses, traffic jams and overwhelmed drains have become recurring monsoon images. Rainfall is often blamed, but rain merely exposes vulnerabilities accumulated over years. Natural drainage channels have been constricted, construction has expanded, open spaces have diminished and civic systems have struggled to keep pace.

The debate over Floor Area Ratio must therefore move beyond how much additional construction a plot can accommodate. Allowing taller buildings and greater built-up area can help cities absorb population growth and limit uncontrolled outward sprawl. But every additional floor also brings more residents, vehicles, sewage, water consumption, electricity demand and pressure on public facilities. Density without corresponding infrastructure does not represent efficient urbanisation; it merely concentrates existing problems.

This principle should apply to every rapidly expanding Indian city. Infrastructure cannot remain an afterthought that governments attempt to retrofit once neighbourhoods have been built. Storm-water drains must account for future densities and changing rainfall patterns. Sewage treatment capacity must expand alongside housing. Public transport should reach developing areas before dependence on private vehicles becomes entrenched. Water availability, groundwater recharge, waste management, pedestrian movement and emergency access must become integral to development decisions. There is also a climate dimension. Extreme rainfall is becoming an increasingly important urban planning consideration, making older assumptions about drainage and land use inadequate. Cities cannot prevent intense rainfall, but they can determine whether it becomes a manageable event or a civic emergency. Protecting wetlands, floodplains and natural drainage systems is therefore as important as constructing new infrastructure.

Gurugram’s experience should be treated as a warning, not an exception. India needs denser cities as urbanisation accelerates, and vertical growth will inevitably be part of that transition. But development cannot be measured merely by towers, commercial space and property values. A successful city is one whose infrastructure can sustain the people occupying those buildings. Before allowing cities to build higher, governments must ensure that their physical, environmental and civic foundations are strong enough to carry the additional weight.

Rethinking Caste, Merit and the IITs

The latest IIT Bombay controversy has revived a difficult debate over caste, institutional accountability and the social foundations of engineering education

HIDDEN HIERARCHIES



DIPANKAR DEY

THE WRITER IS A PROFESSOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION



The recent IIT crisis demands a deeper conversation about ‘inclusion’

In a shocking incident, Sahil Wakode, a second-year engineering student at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay, died by suicide after being found hanging in his hostel room. This is the fourth suicide in the last seven months at the institute. The institute has removed Suryanarayana Doolla as dean of Administrative Affairs following protests by students and political activists. A case of abetment and caste discrimination has been registered against Doolla. The anti-reservation activists have flooded social media with trolls directed at the ‘less meritorious students’ who fail to compete with students belonging to the general category. According to them, reservation deprives other intelligent students of an opportunity to get admission in the IITs.

The parents of Sahil Wakode alleged that he had told them about caste discrimination earlier as well by the professor now named in the FIR related to his suicide. “I told him it’s difficult to secure admission in IIT, and told him to bear it,” said the father, Ravindra Wakode. The father further alleged that the family was not informed promptly about the

death, while his body was sent to a government hospital. “The IIT administration is involved in destroying crucial evidence,” he said. Sadly, it is reported that 45 students from 23 IITs have committed suicide in five years. Out of these, 28 victims were from SC, ST, and OBC communities. Something is definitely wrong with these premier technical institutions of India.

Before entering into further discussion, it should be flagged that the great engineers of medieval India were mainly Shudras – members of the lowest Varna in the caste hierarchy. The Shudras produced a steady supply of architects, builders, stone-masons, bronze sculptors, goldsmiths and other professionals. Commissioned by kings, merchants and Brahmins—who disdained all manual labour themselves—the Shudras, aided by the labour of those considered “untouchable” and outside the Varna hierarchy, built all of India’s engineering marvels, including its grand temple towns, magnificent cities such as Khajuraho, Vijayanagar and medieval fort-palaces. The Harappan civilisation, which flourished

THE DEBATE OVER IITs CANNOT BE SEPARATED FROM THE LONGER SOCIAL HISTORY OF TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

much before the Brahminical caste system took root in ancient India, exhibits an advanced, grid-based urban layout with specialised zoning, standardised burnt bricks, and a sophisticated underground drainage system.

Significantly enough, the smelting traditions of various indigenous groups in India have found their way into a range of literature on iron-ore extraction. Drawings of furnaces used in Birbhum, West Bengal, were included in a journal compiled by the Irish geologist Thomas Oldham. An 1881 geology manual on India contains photographs of smelting and details about the furnaces used by the Agaria, an

Adivasi community in Chota Nagpur. The Asur—an Adivasi community (Scheduled Tribe)—is believed to be India’s first metallurgists. The Asuras’ primary method of metal extraction—procuring charcoal from Sal trees and using it to smelt iron ore—supposedly yielded rust-free iron.

To run its administration and supply trained technical persons to British industries, the colonial rulers established engineering colleges in India. It began in 1843-44, when Civil Engineering classes were introduced at Hindu College, Calcutta, to train engineers for the Public Works Department of the Bengal Presidency. A formal Civil Engineering College was established on November 24, 1856, at the Writers’ Building in Calcutta. With the founding of the University of Calcutta in 1857, the college gained affiliation and, after a brief period under the Presidency College, it was relocated to Shibpur, Howrah in 1880, becoming the Government Engineering College (Bengal Engineering College), Howrah. Thus, the English-educated Bengali Bhadrakols (mostly belonging to upper

castes) entered into this new knowledge system where manual labour was essential.

It may be recalled that in 1946, a 22-member Sarkar Committee, led by businessman Nalini Ranjan Sarkar, recommended establishing four premier technical institutions across India to drive post-war industrial development. The committee explicitly urged that these colleges be designed “along the lines of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)”. Based on the committee’s vision, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and Education Minister Maulana Abul Kalam Azad established the first institute, IIT Kharagpur, in West Bengal. Even after independence, India’s premier technical institutions were built copying Western models.

In her book, *The Caste of Merit: Engineering Education in India* (2019), Ajantha Subramanian provides interesting insights into the colonial history of engineering education and associated racialisation of caste, and the making of IITs in postcolonial India as a Brahmin-upper caste space. She also provides a critical reading of JEE, the merit-testing entrance exam, for admission to IITs and the politics of social reproduction that may be embedded in the idea of prestigious exams. The present crisis at IIT Bombay should be analysed from the historical perspective of racialisation of caste in higher technical institutions of India.

Considering the historical contribution of Sudras and Adivasi communities to the enrichment of technical knowledge, the government can establish, on an experimental basis, a few separate technical institutions, say, an Indian Institute of Traditional Technology (IITT) for students of reserved categories, as suggested by a few social media posts during the ongoing debate. Unlike in IITs, here the students will be allowed to obtain their degrees by creating real-world innovations instead of submitting traditional dissertations.

Views expressed are personal

Human Side of Indian Railways

Modern stations, safer systems and accessible facilities are transforming passenger experience across Indian Railways

CHANGING TRACKS



TASKEEN KHAN

THE WRITER IS AN IRMS OFFICER



Modern trains matter, but the passenger experience remains the true test of progress

platforms, long queues, inadequate waiting spaces and stairs difficult for elderly passengers. Today, the idea of a railway station is gradually changing. The Amrit Bharat Station Scheme is aimed at developing stations with better access, waiting halls, toilets, lifts and escalators, passenger information systems, cleanliness, facilities for Divyangjan and integration with the surrounding city. It also envisages Wi-Fi and spaces for local products through One Station One Product. Good infrastructure is ultimately about making ordinary situations easier for ordinary people.

Technology that works quietly in the background

There is another transformation passengers may not always notice – the increasing use of technology. Railways is moving towards greater use of digital systems, data and artificial intelligence. The most useful technology may be the technology a passenger never notices – preventing safety issues or providing information quickly during delays and platform changes. RailMadad allows passengers to register and track complaints, while 139 is available for assistance. **Safety is not always visible – but it matters the most**

When everything works perfectly, passengers rarely think about railway safety. We board a train and reach our destination without necessarily thinking about signalling systems, track maintenance, inspections, control rooms and thousands of employees whose work makes that journey possible. Technologies such as Kavach are part of

THE FUTURE OF RAILWAYS CANNOT BE DEFINED ONLY BY SPEED

this greater effort towards safety. After joining the service, I began noticing the enormous chain of people and processes behind every journey.

Small facilities can mean big things

Indian Railways has provided facilities for Divyangjan in passenger coaches, including wider entrances, wheelchair spaces and accessible toilets, while Braille signage is being provided in newly manufactured coaches and retrofitted progressively in existing coaches. For a visually impaired passenger, a Braille sign can mean greater independence. Public infrastructure should be

judged not only by how much has been built, but by who can use it and how easily. **Cleanliness is everyone’s responsibility**

The widespread adoption of bio-toilets has helped prevent human waste from being discharged directly onto tracks. But infrastructure and technology can go only so far. A clean railway also requires better habits and better citizenship from passengers.

People behind the railway

During my short-film shoot, I became more conscious of employees who rarely become part of the passenger’s story – ticket checkers, cleaning and station staff, maintenance workers, RPF personnel and loco pilots. We often remember the train but rarely the people who make it possible. The transformation of Indian Railways is also about the people who run the system every day.

Passengers have a role too

We often ask what Indian Railways is doing for us. Perhaps we

should occasionally ask what we are doing for Indian Railways. Can we keep our coach clean, respect reserved spaces for elderly and Divyangjan passengers and follow safety instructions? A public transport system can only become as good as the relationship between the institution and the people it serves.

The journey ahead

When I look back at that short-film shoot today, what stays with me is the diversity of people I saw travelling through the railway system. Everyone was going somewhere. Everyone had a story. And everyone expected the Railway to get them there safely. The future railway cannot be defined only by speed. It has to be defined by safety, accessibility, cleanliness, technology, reliability and dignity.

The most meaningful transformation will be the one a passenger feels without needing to understand the technology behind it. A grandmother should be able to find her platform without anxiety. A Divyang passenger should be able to move independently. And when the train finally pulls into the destination station, the passenger should feel that the journey was not merely completed – it was cared for.

That is the Indian Railway I saw glimpses of during my short-film journey. And that is the railway journey we should continue building – one in which India’s progress is measured not merely by how fast its trains move, but by how comfortably, safely and inclusively its people move with them.

Views expressed are personal

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Call it what it is

SSAI’s proposal to prevent non-dairy analogue products from being sold as paneer is a welcome consumer-protection measure. Products containing non-milk substitutes should be clearly labelled rather than marketed under familiar dairy names. Strong enforcement, particularly across restaurants and online platforms, will be essential to prevent deception and protect public trust.

PRIYA NAIR, BENGALURU

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

News at a glance

Pak: 2 Afghans among 9 militants killed in Balochistan

KARACHI: Pakistan security forces on Thursday said two Afghan nationals were among nine terrorists killed in Balochistan's Mastung district on Wednesday.

As per police, nine terrorists were killed on Wednesday after they attempted to attack a security post in Kanak Valley. Among 9 terrorists killed, two turned out to be Afghan nationals, police said. official. "One Afghan was identified as Zulfikar alias Abu Umar through a Directorate of Afghan Intelligence card found on him," the official said.

Senate to vote on resolution to halt the Iran war

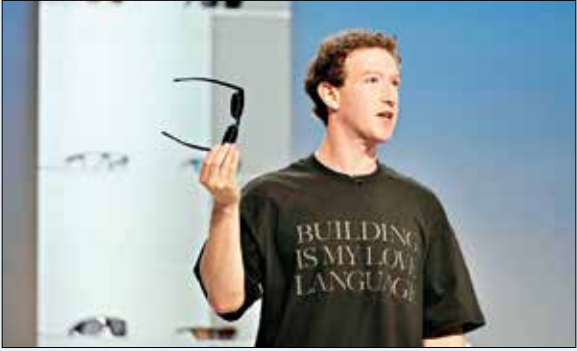
WASHINGTON: Increasingly anxious about the Iran war, senators are set to vote Thursday on a war powers resolution seeking to halt President Donald Trump's military action, which has been largely blamed for the spike in fuel prices and become a flashpoint in the midterm election.

The Senate vote, days after Trump's bombastic address to the United Nations in which he threatened to "annihilate" Iran, is likely to be the last chance for lawmakers to go on record about the war ahead of November.

Judge orders WH to restore access to barred news outlets

NEW YORK: Hours after a federal judge ordered President Donald Trump to lift a ban on three news outlets from White House grounds, reporters from two of the outlets had been let in.

Early Thursday afternoon, CNN and MS NOW journalists were now back at the White House, after being denied access in the morning. A federal judge temporarily blocked President Donald Trump's ban of three news outlets from the White House, ordering early Thursday that CNN, MS NOW and Politico must have their access restored.



Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg speaks during the Meta Connect conference in Menlo Park

AP/PTI

Brief

Pak security forces kill 8 militants

PESHAWAR: Pakistan security forces killed eight suspected militants in an intelligence-based operation on Thursday in north-western Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, police said.

The operation was launched after intelligence reports indicated the presence of militants in North Waziristan district, a police official said. Eight militants were killed in the exchange of fire, the official said.

Police destroyed the hideout of the militants and a large number of weapons, ammunition and other military equipment were recovered from their possession.

Netanyahu arrives in New York

DUBAI: Israel's increasingly isolated Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has arrived in New York to address the United Nations General Assembly, but no meeting with US President Donald Trump is planned.

Meanwhile, a top European Union official says only a small amount of the funds needed to rebuild the war-shattered Gaza Strip has been collected.

The Israeli prime minister's brief stay in New York for his speech at the UN General Assembly includes meetings with several world leaders, according to his office -- but not Trump, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio or any Arab leaders.

Nepal: Indian man held for smuggling

KATHMANDU: An Indian national was among two people arrested on Thursday at Nepal's international airport for possessing more than half a kilogram of illegal gold, authorities said.

Mohammad Chera Thodi, 42, was arrested from the parking area of the Tribhuvan International Airport in Kathmandu when the police followed him as his activities were suspicious. Thodi arrived from Doha on a Qatar Airways flight. During a security check, authorities recovered 536 grams of illegal gold from his luggage.

TRUMP VOWS TO WORK TOWARDS FORGING BETTER FUTURE

Let's race, not wrestle: Xi at White House

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 24

Chinese President Xi Jinping began his second state visit to the US on Thursday with a formal welcome at the White House by his US counterpart Donald Trump, who vowed to work towards forging a better future for the two nations.

Trump and the First Lady Melania greeted Xi and his wife, Peng Liyuan, at the South Portico of the White House as a military band played. The Chinese leader arrived in a black SUV Hongqi ("Red Flag") N701, an equivalent of the Beast used by the US President.

The two couples stood together briefly on a red carpet before heading inside. "Just as our people worked together to win that war, President Xi and I will continue



US President Donald Trump (right), greets China's President Xi Jinping on the South Portico of the White House on, Thursday

AP/PTI

working together to forge a better future for both of our nations,"

Trump said in brief opening remarks at the White House, recalling America's

role in World War II. Trump said he and Xi have forged a "truly great

HIGHLIGHTS

- » No major US TV network aired live footage of the Trump and Xi meeting or the ceremonies at the White House
- » Xi said that the two countries had a responsibility to ensure that humans always operate AI
- » US President Trump said he and Xi have forged a "truly great friendship" since his first election in 2016

friendship" since his first election in 2016, built on mutual respect and the vital interest of "our people". No major US TV network aired live footage of the Trump and Xi meeting or the ceremonies at the White House.

In his opening remarks, Xi said he was visiting the US at President Trump's invitation to "carry on our friend-

ship, expand cooperation, and promote the well-being of both our peoples."

"We should coexist in peace. As I have said many times, China and the United States as two major countries stand to gain from cooperation and will both lose in confrontation," Xi said in the remarks delivered at the ceremony in the Grand Foyer of the White House.

He said the two countries should avoid the "Thucydides Trap," the theory that a rising power and an established power are likely to go to war.

"We do not need to avoid mentioning competition, but our competition should be a healthy one, and should be kept within bounds. It should be a race of catching up with one another, not a wrestle in which when either wins, or loses," Xi said.

Saudi coalition says 6 ballistic missiles intercepted

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September 24

Six ballistic missiles targeting Saudi Arabia's port of Yanbu on the Red Sea and the southwestern city of Taif have been intercepted, a Saudi military spokesperson said Thursday, blaming Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen as fighting escalates.

The Houthis later claimed they fired dozens of ballistic missiles and drones at the kingdom's southwestern Jazan province.

In recent days, they have been blamed for attempted attacks on the kingdom, including on Riyadh, the Saudi capital.

The statement by Saudi Maj Gen Turki al-Malki, who is also the spokesperson for the Saudi-led coalition fighting the Houthis, followed alerts by Saudi civil defence authorities.

Rights group says some people it classified as journalists killed in Gaza were militants

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September 24

The Committee to Protect Journalists said Thursday that 19 Palestinians killed by Israeli fire who it had previously identified as journalists or media workers were actually militants or participants in combat. After a review of its tally, it says Israeli forces have killed 191 Palestinian journalists and media workers since the start of the war in Gaza. The New York-based CPJ says it regularly updates its findings as new information comes to light. It removed another three Palestinians from its list because their role as journalists could not be established. It reinstated six cases, including two Israeli journalists killed in Hamas' Oct 7, 2023, attack that started the war.

"The accuracy and credibility of CPJ's research are fundamental to our mission," CEO Jodie Ginsberg said in a statement. "We base the determinations we make solely on whether indi-



Representational Image

ISRAEL DENIES TARGETING JOURNALISTS AND HAS SAID A NUMBER OF SLAIN JOURNALISTS WERE MEMBERS OF HAMAS OR OTHER ARMED GROUPS POSING AS REPORTERS

viduals meet our definitions of who we consider to be a journalist, not an individual's affiliation or

views, nor in response to pressure or intimidation from any government or interest group."

The group said that even after the review, its figures show that Israeli forces were responsible for "by far the majority of killings of journalists and media workers worldwide since 2023."

Among those killed during the war was Mariam Dagga, a visual journalist who worked for The Associated Press and other outlets. She was killed, along with 21 other people, including rescue

workers and other journalists, when Israel carried out a double strike on a Gaza hospital in August 2025.

Israel denies targeting journalists and has said a number of slain journalists were members of Hamas or other armed groups posing as reporters. In some cases, it has provided evidence of such ties that was rejected by their employers.

The Israeli prime minister's office and the military did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Critics accuse Israel of deliberately targeting journalists to silence war coverage. Israel has barred foreign reporters from entering Gaza outside of brief military-run visits since the start of the war. CPJ says that it considers all Palestinian journalists killed in Gaza to have been killed in connection with their work since they can do their work anywhere and because they are not allowed to leave the territory.

Zelenskyy, at UN, urges leaders to keep choking Russia's revenues

Russian strikes kill 8 people in Ukraine

ASSOCIATED PRESS
United Nations, September 24

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy told world leaders Wednesday that Vladimir Putin is the only obstacle to ending "the ridiculous and never-ending war," and he urged nations large and small to pressure the Russian president for peace by choking the country's revenues and impeding its war efforts.

"Our target is Russia's ability to finance this war, to drag it out, to make it more brutal and more destructive," Zelenskyy told the UN General Assembly's annual gathering. "Russia's finances and Russia's production are what must be stopped if Putin is to be stopped."

When Russia gets money from trade, "it always says no to diplomacy," Zelenskyy argued, "so Russia's revenues must remain a target." Earlier Wednesday, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov clashed with Ukrainian



Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

RUSSIA'S FINANCES AND RUSSIA'S PRODUCTION ARE WHAT MUST BE STOPPED IF PUTIN IS TO BE STOPPED

Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha and his country's European supporters at a UN Security Council meeting, and Lavrov and US

Secretary of State Marco Rubio met on the assembly sidelines and discussed the war. Russian drone and missile attacks on Ukraine overnight killed at least eight civilians, officials said Thursday.

A strike on Ukraine's northeastern Kharkiv region killed six agricultural workers and wounded 12 others, Interior Minister Ihor Vyshvskiy said. An attack on the capital Kyiv killed a man and a woman, he said.

Far-right UK activist arrested in English Channel

Daniel Thomas was taken into custody for allegedly slashing a dinghy in the water

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London September 24

A far-right activist who has led protests against migrants crossing the English Channel in small boats has been arrested for allegedly slashing a dinghy in the water.

A video posted on social media appears to show Daniel Thomas, 37, taking a knife to an inflatable boat, which was empty of

BRITISH POLICE DO NOT IDENTIFY SUSPECTS BY NAME UNTIL THEY ARE CHARGED

migrants but had a rescue services member aboard, while shouting "You're in English territory."

Hampshire and Isle of Wight Constabulary said Thursday that a 37-year-old

man was arrested the previous evening on suspicion of criminal damage with intent to endanger life and endangering the safety of a vessel. It said he remained in custody on Thursday.

British police do not identify suspects by name until they are charged.

Thomas, who goes by the nickname Danny Tommo, is a longtime associate of far-right activist Stephen Yaxley-Lennon,

also known as Tommy Robinson. Patriot Platform, a group Thomas founded, is behind recent protests in which masked, black-clad men tried to stop migrants reaching the UK.

Earlier this month, masked demonstrators blocked the port of Dover, in southeast England, and tried to stop migrants being taken ashore in Portsmouth on the country's south coast.

Successive UK governments have struggled to stop people -- more than 41,000 last year -- making the dangerous journey across one of the world's busiest shipping lanes. The issue has been depicted as a crisis by politicians including Nigel Farage of the hard-right party Reform UK, and has been used as a rallying point by anti-immigration activists.

PML-N's Najeeb Naqi elected as PoK 'Prez'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 24

Najeeb Naqi of the ruling Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N) was on Thursday elected as the "President" of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK).

He secured 32 votes, while his challenger Chaudhry Latif Akbar of Pakistan Peoples Party got 13 votes in the election held at PoK's so-called legisla-

tive assembly. Only assembly members were eligible to vote. Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif congratulated Naqi on his victory and conveyed his best wishes, according to a statement issued by the PM's office. Naqi has previously served as health minister. The office of "president" had been vacant since January following the death of Sultan Mahmood Chaudhry.

TIGHTENS RULES Italy approves limits on non-Italian speakers, veils in classrooms



Premier Giorgia Meloni

ASSOCIATED PRESS Rome, September 24

Italy's government passed a decree Thursday to place an upper limit on the number of students in each school classroom who have only limited Italian language skills and to ban face-covering Islamic veils in schools.

Premier Giorgia Meloni's conservative government said the package is aimed at strengthening integration through language learning and has drawn support from right-wing allies. Opponents including some educators, unions and opposition parties warn that new rules could force students to attend schools far from their neighbourhoods, while critics accuse the government of turning immigration into a political issue.

With elections possible as early as next spring, analysts say the measures allow the premier to reassert her credentials on issues central to her conservative base, even

UNDER THE PLAN, A LIMIT OF 30 PER CENT OF STUDENTS LACKING SUFFICIENT ITALIAN PROFICIENCY WOULD BE ALLOWED IN ANY INDIVIDUAL CLASSROOM

though their impact is likely to be limited and significant questions remain about how they would be enforced. Under the plan, a limit of 30 per cent of students lacking sufficient Italian proficiency would be allowed in any individual classroom. The threshold would be based on language skills rather than citizenship and would also apply to students from other European Union countries who do not speak Italian.

The government decree goes into effect immediately but needs to be endorsed within 60 days in parliament, where Meloni's coalition commands a majority.

UK's Home Secretary orders 'urgent review' over illegal migration

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA London, September 24

UK Home Secretary Shabana Mahmood has ordered an "urgent review" after two boats carrying hundreds of illegal migrants landed on the country's shores over two consecutive days this week.

The Cabinet minister, of South Asian heritage, said in a statement on Wednesday that it was "not acceptable" that the UK's Border Force had failed to stop the boatloads before they reached the Kent coast on Monday and Tuesday.

It came after the Border Security Command detained 21 people following a boat arrival on the beach of Samphire Hoe in Dover.

"Our improved monitoring has led to uncontrolled crossings becoming incredibly rare, but even one is one too many," said Mahmood. "That is why I have ordered an urgent review by the Border Security Command into how this happened, and what must be done to ensure it doesn't happen again," she said.

Amid mounting criticism from the Opposition Conservatives, the minister said that new tactics adopted by people smugglers, including launching

small boats from much further west in France, were "a reminder of two things".

"Firstly, these gangs have no regard for human life. They are putting people on increasingly long and dangerous crossings. Secondly, our efforts are having an impact. We are making it much harder for gangs to launch vessels, forcing them to change their approach, and as a result we are significantly reducing the numbers coming here by small boat," she said.

Thousands of migrants crossing the English Channel from France are usually brought to shore by Border Security Command or Royal National Lifeboat Institution (RNLI) boats, with more uncontrolled landings of this nature rare.

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER NATIONAL HIGHWAY DIVISION, RANCHI Din Dayal Nagar, Booty Road, Ranchi - 834008

2nd CORRIGENDUM OF TENDER

This is to notify the concerned that the tender published in news paper by PR 388709 Road(26-27),D and PR 390136 Road(26-27) D with Tender Reference Number- NH/RANCHI/SBD/2026-27/02 for the work " Construction of drain and culvert in between Km. 0.000 to Km. 39.100 of NH-143 AG under Special Repair (SR) under NH Division, Ranchi, Jharkhand for the year 2026-27 " has been revised and the name of the work will be read as " Construction of drain in Km 3rd, 4th, 6th, 7th, 14th, 15th & 16th and culvert of chainage 3+200 of NH-143AG under Special Repair (SR) under under NH Division, Ranchi, Jharkhand for the year 2026-27".

Executive Engineer National Highway Division, Ranchi

PR 390402 (Road) 26-27 (D)

NORTHERN RAILWAY Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-procurement system

Sr.DMM, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the president of India invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing time
01	93266328	Scrap Baling Machine	04 Unit	22.10.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e., www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Sr.DMM/NS/ILP/93266328/2026 Date: 24.09.2026 3315/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

SOUTHERN RAILWAY CARRIAGE & WAGON WORKS

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage and Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayangavaram, Chennai-600 023 invites e-tender for the following work as per the tender notice given in e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in.

Tender No.	MLR-INT-FUR-ELE-0926
Name of the work	INTERIOR FURNISHING AND ELECTRICAL ATTENTION IN LHS AC COACHES DURING MLR
Approximate Cash Value ₹	21,62,78,340.20
Bid Security / Earnest Money ₹	43,25,600.00
Bidding start date	05/10/2026
Tender closing date and time	19/10/2026 15:00 Hrs
Cost of tender form	Nil
Period of Completion	24 months

Website Address www.ireps.gov.in
Office Address Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayangavaram, Chennai - 600 023.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज आवश्यक सूचना

इस कार्यालय के द्वारा आमंत्रित ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD / SD / SAHIBGANJ / 04 / 2026-27,जिसका P.R.No.389260 (District) (26-27) D अपरिहार्य कारणवश अगले आदेश तक स्थगित की जाती है :-

कार्यपालक अभियंता ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, PR 390342 Rural Development (26-27) D साहेबगंज

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN U40109TG1997PLC028483

(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guna Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL) (A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

MOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

- Tender Enquiry No. 193/GATP/IMD/AHP/20017516 dated 23/09/2026 "Rotary Actuators for the operation of Dome Valves from GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB" Area of 2X270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Dist.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 24/09/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

GATP-87/26 PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/15536

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely Arvind Kumar Suman Prop. M/s. R.K. Enterprises R/o: H. No. RZ-3284, First Floor, G.No.-37, Tuglakabad, Extn. New Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in CC No. 1606/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act, registered at P.S.: Anand Vihar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Arvind Kumar Suman cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Arvind Kumar Suman has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Arvind Kumar Suman accused CC No. 1606/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act, registered at P.S.: Anand Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 28.10.2026.

By Order Deepakshi Rana Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 Room No. 19, First Floor, Shahdara, Karkardoom Courts, Delhi

DP/13434/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED (An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)

H.O. "UJVN LIMITED" MAHARAJ GATE, GATE ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248008, U.T. INDIA UJVN/2026/SC02066

Tel.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvn.com

Tender No. 860 Date : 24.09.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

The office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :

Tender No: NIT-42/EE(M)/MB-II/26-27, NIT-43/EE(M)/MB-II/26-27 & NIT-44/EE(M)/MB-II/26-27

Name of work / Supply/Services: 1. Procurement of general spares for Turbines at Dharasu Power House, MB-II Uttarkashi.

2.Procurement of Dial Type Temperature (DTT) Detector at Dharasu Power House, MB-II.

3.Procurement of Upper Fixed Labyrinths for 76 MW Turbines at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi

Estimated cost: ₹ 17,25,100.00 + GST Extra, ₹ 5,47,800.00 + GST Extra, & ₹ 41,64,800.00 + GST Extra

Availability of bid document on website: 24.09.2026 from 16:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of bids on website: 16.10.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

State Urban Development Agency, Chhattisgarh

4th Floor, D Block, Indrawati Bhawan (HOD Building), Nova Raipur Atal Nagar, Chhattisgarh, 492002

Phone 0771-2222401 Fax 0771/2222409 Email: csd.suda@yahoo.com

RFP Notice (2nd Call)

RFP Reference No.: PROJ-204/201/2026-SUDA (T M F) SECTION / 407826-47

Nava Raipur Atal Nagar, Dated 21/09/2026

The State Urban Development Agency (SUDA), Chhattisgarh hereby invites proposals in conformity with the RFP document from registered and authorized agencies having experience and expertise in the similar field of work as per the criteria mentioned in the RFP document as below:

System Tender No.	Name of the Work	EMD	RFP Document Fee	Last date to download the RFP
199810	"Request for Proposal (RFP) for Development, Operation and Maintenance of Regional Sanitary Landfill Facilities for Durg Division of Chhattisgarh on DBOT mode, Package II (2 nd Call)."	INR 5,00,000/-	INR 10,000/-	07/10/2026

The details regarding conditions stipulated in the RFP, EMD, Key dates for submission, detailed RFP, RFP document and all the information related to the RFP can be viewed and downloaded from e-procurement portal <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> or departmental website <https://suad.cg.gov.in>.

SD/- Chief Executive Officer State Urban Development Agency, Nava Raipur Atal Nagar

samvad 49163/3

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS! IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF MORE FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS - 2026

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during this Festival Season, Railways have decided to run the following additional Festival Special Trains as per details given below:-

01703/01704 Jabalpur - Haridwar - Jabalpur Express Special Train (Weekly)						10 Trips
Train No. 01703	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 01704
---	15:30	---	Jabalpur	16:20	---	---
14:20	---	---	Haridwar	---	15:10	---

DAYS OF RUN: 01703 Ex. Jabalpur on every Thursday from 22.10.2026 to 19.11.2026 and 01704 Ex. Haridwar on every Friday from 23.10.2026 to 20.11.2026.

STOPPAGES: Katni Murwara, Damoh, Saugor, Bina Malkheri, Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi Jn., Gwalior Jn., Agra Cantt, Aligarh Jn., Khurja Jn., Hapur, Meerut City & Roorkee Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

01707/01708 Jabalpur - Hazrat Nizamuddin - Jabalpur Express Special Train (Weekly)						10 Trips
Train No. 01707	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 01708
---	20:20	---	Jabalpur	09:30	---	---
14:25	---	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	15:45	---

DAYS OF RUN: 01707 Ex. Jabalpur on every Saturday from 17.10.2026 to 14.11.2026 and 01708 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin on every Sunday from 18.10.2026 to 15.11.2026.

STOPPAGES: Katni Murwara, Damoh, Saugor, Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi Jn., Gwalior Jn., Dhaulpur, Agra Cantt, Mathura Jn. & Kosi Kalan Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

04731/04732 Shri Ganganagar - Samastipur Jn. - Shri Ganganagar Express Special Train (Weekly)						14 Trips
Train No. 04731	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04732
---	13:25	---	Shri Ganganagar	12:20	---	---
00:25	00:35	---	Delhi Jn.	23:40	23:50	---
23:15	---	---	Samastipur Jn.	---	00:45	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04731 Ex. Shri Ganganagar on every Sunday from 18.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04732 Ex. Samastipur Jn. on every Tuesday from 20.10.2026 to 01.12.2026.

STOPPAGES: Sadulshahr, Hanumangarh Jn., Sangaria, Mandi Dabwali, Raman, Sirsa, Mandi Adampur, Hisar, Hansi, Rohtak Jn., Delhi Jn., Ghaziabad, Moradabad, Bareilly, Sitapur Jn., Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur Jn., Chhapra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn. & Muzaffarpur Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

03435/03436 Malda Town - Anand Vihar (T) - Malda Town Express Special Train (Weekly)						16 Trips
Train No. 03435	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 03436
---	09:30	---	Malda Town	22:30	---	---
13:40	---	---	Anand Vihar (T)	---	14:50	---

DAYS OF RUN: 03435 Ex. Malda Town on every Monday from 12.10.2026 to 30.11.2026 and 03436 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on every Tuesday from 13.10.2026 to 01.12.2026.

STOPPAGES: New Farakka, Barharwa Jn., Sahibganj Jn., Pirpainti, Kahalgaon, Bhagalpur, Sultanganj, Jamalpur Jn., Abhaipur, Kiul Jn., Sheikpura, Warisali Ganj, Nawadah, Tilaya, Gaya Jn., Anugraha Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Subedarganj, Govinpur & Tundla Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

05742/05741 New Jalpaiguri - Gomti Nagar - New Jalpaiguri Express Special Train (Weekly)						18 Trips
Train No. 05742	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 05741
---	08:30	---	New Jalpaiguri	15:00	---	---
09:10	---	---	Gomti Nagar	---	12:20	---

DAYS OF RUN: 05742 Ex. New Jalpaiguri on every Sunday from 04.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 05741 Ex. Gomti Nagar on every Monday from 05.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.

STOPPAGES: Siliguri Jn., Thakurganj, Arariya Court, Purnia, Katihar Jn., Naugachia, Mansi Jn., Khagaria Jn., Salauna, Hasanpur Road, Rusera Ghat, Samastipur, Muzaffarpur, Hajipur Jn., Sonpur Jn., Chhapra, Siwan Jn., Deoria Sadar, Gorakhpur Jn., Basti, Mankapur Jn., Ayodhya Dham Jn. & Barabanki Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

04604/04603 Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra - Varanasi Jn. - Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra Superfast Special Express Train (Weekly)						18 Trips
Train No. 04604	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04603
---	18:15	---	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra	04:30	---	---
18:30	---	---	Varanasi Jn.	---	04:30	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04604 Ex. Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra on every Sunday from 04.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04603 Ex. Varanasi Jn. on every Tuesday from 06.10.2026 to 01.12.2026.

STOPPAGES: Martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan, Jammu Tawi, Pathankot Cantt, Jalandhar Cantt, Ludhiana, Ambala Cantt, Saharanpur, Moradabad, Bareilly, Alamnagar, Rae Bareilly Jn. & Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.

04604/04603 Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra - Varanasi Jn. - Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra Superfast Special Express Train (Weekly)						18 Trips
Train No. 04604	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04603
---	18:15	---	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra	04:30	---	---
18:30	---	---	Varanasi Jn.	---	04:30	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04604 Ex. Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra on every Sunday from 04.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04603 Ex. Varanasi Jn. on every Tuesday from 06.10.2026 to 01.12.2026.

STOPPAGES: Martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan, Jammu Tawi, Pathankot Cantt, Jalandhar Cantt, Ludhiana, Ambala Cantt, Saharanpur, Moradabad, Bareilly, Alamnagar, Rae Bareilly Jn. & Maa Belha Devi Dham Pratappgarh Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Vinod @ Vicky S/o Chander Sen R/o 3042, B-Block Gali No.76, Near Choudhary Dairy Sant Nagar Burari Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.533/2021 U/s 394/397/411/34 IPC & 3/181 MV Act at PS: Darya Ganj, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Vinod @ Vicky can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Vinod @ Vicky has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Vinod @ Vicky of FIR No. 533/2021 U/s 394/397/411/34 IPC & 3/181 MV Act of PS: Darya Ganj, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.10.2026.

By order Abhishek Goyal Additional Session Judge-03 Central District, Room No. 143, 1st Floor Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13595/CD/2026

04610/04609 Jammu Tawi - Varanasi Jn. - Jammu Tawi Special Express Train (Weekly)						18 Trips
Train No. 04610	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04609
---	05:15	---	Jammu Tawi	08:30	---	---
23:55	00:05	---	Lucknow Jn.	13:20	13:30	---
05:10	---	---	Varanasi Jn.	---	09:00	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04610 Ex. Jammu Tawi on every Thursday from 01.10.2026 to 26.11.2026 and 04609 Ex. Varanasi Jn. on every Friday from 02.10.2026 to 27.11.2026.

STOPPAGES: Pathankot Cantt, Jalandhar Cantt, Dhandari Kalan, Ambala Cantt, Saharanpur, Moradabad, Shahjahanpur, Lucknow Jn. & Sultanpur Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 3 Tier Economy.

04081/04082 New Delhi - Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra - New Delhi Special Express Train (Daily)						28 Trips
Train No. 04081	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04082
---	23:45	---	New Delhi	10:00	---	---
12:00	---	---	Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra	---	21:00	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04081 Ex. New Delhi from 12.10.2026 to 25.10.2026 (Daily) and 04082 Ex. Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra from 13.10.2026 to 26.10.2026 (Daily).

STOPPAGES: Panipat, Kurukshetra Jn., Ambala Cantt, Ludhiana Jn., Jalandhar Cantt, Pathankot Cantt, Jammu Tawi & Martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

01941/01942 Agra Cantt - Palwal - Agra Cantt Unreserved MEMU Special Train (Daily)						82 Trips
Train No. 01941	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 01942
---	06:30	---	Agra Cantt	13:00	---	---
09:45	---	---	Palwal	---	10:00	---

DAYS OF RUN: 01941 Ex. Agra Cantt and 01942 Ex. Palwal (Daily) up to 31.10.2026.

STOPPAGES: Runkula, Bad, Mathura Jn., Chata, Kosi Kalan & Hodal Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

04183/04184 Prayagraj Jn. - Hazrat Nizamuddin - Prayagraj Jn. Special Express Train						14 Trips
Train No. 04183	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04184
---	15:25	---	Prayagraj Jn.	09:10	---	---
11:35	---	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	---	15:45	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04183 Ex. Prayagraj Jn. on every Tuesday from 20.10.2026 to 01.12.2026 and 04184 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin on every Wednesday from 21.10.2026 to 02.12.2026.

STOPPAGES: Shankargarh, Dabhaura, Manikpur, Chitrakut Dham, Atarra, Banda, Mahoba, Kulpahar, Harpalpur, Mauranipur, Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi, Gwalior, Dhaulpur, Agra Cantt, Mathura Jn. & Kosikalan Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

04098/04097 Shakurbasti - Darbhanga - Shakurbasti Special Express Train (6 Days a Week)						104 Trips
Train No. 04098	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	ARR.	DEP.	Train No. 04097
---	09:20	---	Shakurbasti	18:00	---	---
11:45	---	---	Darbhanga	---	14:00	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04098 Ex. Shakurbasti from 01.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 (6 Days a Week Except Tuesday) and 04097 Ex. Darbhanga from 02.10.2026 to 30.11.2026 (6 Days a Week Except Wednesday).

STOPPAGES: New Delhi, Ghaziabad, Kanpur, Unnao Jn., Aishbagh, Badshahnagar, Barabanki Jn., Burhwal Jn., Gonda, Gorakhpur, Kaptanganj Jn., Siswa Bazar, Bagaha, Narkatiaganj Jn., Sikta, Raxaul Jn., Ghorasahan, Bairagnia, Sitamarhi, Janakpur Road & Kamtaul Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.

Revised Frequency & Days of Run of Train No. 04052/04051 New Delhi - Howrah Jn. - New Delhi Special Train (from Weekly to Tri-weekly)		
Train No. & Name	Earlier Notified Frequency & Day of Run	Revised Frequency & Day of Run
04052 New Delhi - Howrah Jn. Special	Friday (Weekly)	Friday, Sunday & Tuesday (Tri- Weekly)
04051 Howrah Jn. - New Delhi Special	Sunday (Weekly)	Sunday, Tuesday & Thursday (Tri- Weekly)

Train No. & Name			Earlier Notified Dates/Trips	Revised Dates/Trips
04052 New Delhi - Howrah Jn. Special	09.10.26 to 27.11.26 (08 Trips)	06.10.26 to 29.11.26 (24 Trips)		
04051 Howrah Jn. - New Delhi Special	11.10.26 to 29.11.26 (08 Trips)	08.10.26 to 01.12.26 (24 Trips)		

For any kind of information, passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in

Download RailMadad app.

Please join us on

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Your Convenience - Our Concern

Visit us at : www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

News at a glance

PhonePe to hire 20K sales persons, deploy 50L devices

NEW DELHI: PhonePe on Thursday announced plans to accelerate merchant expansion across towns and villages, hiring more than 20,000 frontline sales personnel over the next year.

The company will deploy more than 50 lakh payment devices, including SmartSpeakers and POS devices, over the next 12 months, with approximately 50 per cent in rural India, including Tier 6 towns.

PhonePe said the recently announced MDR framework and a dedicated fund using 5 per cent of MDR collections for small merchant expansion will support investments.

IHCL to open 78-key Ginger Jorhat in Assam

MUMBAI: Indian Hotels Company Limited (IHCL) on Thursday announced the opening of 78-key Ginger Jorhat, in Assam.

"The opening of Ginger Jorhat in Assam strengthens the brand's presence in the Northeast region," Indian Hotels Company Limited Executive Vice President, Select Service Business," Deepika Rao said.

"This opening is in line with our strategy of expanding across emerging markets and offering guests Ginger's signature blend of lean luxe hospitality and seamless experiences," she added.

Anarock acquires 51% stake in DSP Design Associates

NEW DELHI: Anarock Group has acquired a 51 per cent stake in architecture firm DSP Design Associates at an enterprise value of around Rs 400 crore, as part of its expansion plan.

Mumbai-based Anarock, a leading property consultant, posted turnover of around Rs 950 crore in the last fiscal. DSP is a multidisciplinary architecture, master planning and interior design firm.

Anarock Founder and Chairman Anuj Puri said the acquisition will strengthen its Project Management & Engineering Services and advisory businesses.

Govt warns public against non-compliant Nidhi cos

NEW DELHI: The government on Thursday cautioned the public against investing in non-compliant Nidhi companies promising unusually high returns & advised due diligence. Nidhi firms can accept deposits & provide loans only to members & are regulated under Companies Act, 2013 & Nidhi Rules, 2014.

Only 395 entities have been declared Nidhi companies. The ministry said many entities failed to comply with rules or submit mandatory NDH-4 applications within time. Deposits with Nidhi companies are not insured by DICGC, making recovery difficult in cases of fraud or failure.

BECOMES WORLD'S 7TH MOST VALUABLE EXCHANGE

NSE ends nearly 2% higher in stock mkt debut, valued at ₹4.49 lakh crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 24

National Stock Exchange of India shares closed nearly 2 per cent higher in their market debut on Thursday, valuing the bourse at Rs 4.49 lakh crore and placing it among the world's top seven exchanges.

The stock listed at Rs 1,800, marginally up by 0.84 per cent from the issue price of Rs 1,785 on the BSE. During the trade, shares surged 5.21 per cent to Rs 1,878 before closing at Rs 1,818, higher by 1.85 per cent.

NSE commanded a market valuation of Rs 4,49,955 crore and ranked 11th among the most valued firms on BSE.

Reliance Industries is the country's most valued firm with a market valuation of Rs 16,49,616.47 crore, followed by HDFC Bank Rs 11,24,571.19 crore, Bharti Airtel Rs 11,17,673.74 crore, ICICI Bank Rs 9,56,171.08 crore, SBI Rs 9,03,230.53 crore, TCS Rs 7,51,476.78 crore, Bajaj Finance Rs 6,12,104.96 crore, Larsen & Toubro Rs 5,29,031.62 crore, LIC Rs 5,13,589.81 crore and Hindustan Unilever 4,54,175.99 crore, as per BSE data.

Earlier in the day, NSE entered the elite club of top



NSE, MD and Chief Executive Officer Ashishkumar Chauhan, NSE Chairperson Srinivas Injeti, BSE Chief Executive Officer Sundararaman Ramamurthy and others during the listing ceremony of NSE, in Mumbai on Thursday

PTI

10 valued firms by market valuation, grabbing the tenth place ahead of Hindustan Unilever. However, at close, Hindustan Unilever raced ahead of NSE in terms of market capitalisation (mcap).

Peer BSE has a market valuation of Rs 1.29 lakh crore. NSE also became the world's seventh most valuable exchange by mcap.

United States' CME Group has a market valuation of \$97.37 billion, followed by Intercontinental Exchange whose market cap was \$87.77 billion,

Hong Kong Exchanges & Clearing \$63.40 billion, Germany's Deutsche Börse \$58.09 billion, Nasdaq \$53.34 billion, London Stock Exchange \$52.89 billion, NSE \$46.87 billion, United States' Cboe Global Markets \$28.07 billion, Singapore Exchange \$18.75 billion and Netherlands Euronext \$18.12 billion.

The Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of NSE, the country's second-largest IPO, received nearly 6 times subscription on the final day of bidding on Monday, led by strong

demand from institutional buyers.

The offering was India's second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India's Rs 27,870-crore IPO in 2024. The IPO surpassed LIC's Rs 21,000 crore offering in 2022.

The public issue marked a significant milestone for the NSE, whose listing plans had remained stalled for nearly a decade amid regulatory hurdles, including those linked to the co-location controversy.

The mega IPO generated nearly Rs 90,300 crore of

KEY POINTS

» NSE commanded a market valuation of Rs 4,49,955 crore and ranked 11th among the most valued firms on BSE

» Earlier in the day, NSE entered the elite club of top 10 valued firms by market valuation, grabbing the tenth place ahead of Hindustan Unilever

» The Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of NSE, the country's second-largest IPO, received nearly 6 times subscription on the final day of bidding on Monday

» The mega IPO generated nearly Rs 90,300 crore of demand against the Rs 22,568 crore issue size

demand against the Rs 22,568 crore issue size. The IPO had an Offer for Sale of up to 12.64 crore equity shares by existing shareholders. The exchange had fixed a price band of Rs 1,700-1,785 per equity share for the IPO.

NSE was incorporated in 1992 and recognised as a stock exchange by SEBI in April 1993. It commenced operations in 1994 with the launch of the wholesale debt market, followed shortly after by the launch of the cash market segment.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 24

The National Stock Exchange, which made its stock market debut on Thursday, does not see any change in its duties as a stock trading marketplace and responsibilities as a commercial entity, its chairperson Srinivas Injeti said. However, if the two lines intersect, the former will have an overriding advantage, he said.

The NSE as an institution has contributed immensely in transforming the Indian capital market from a relatively small market serving a privileged few to a nationwide and vibrant capital market today, he said.

Earlier in the day, shares of the National Stock Exchange started trading on the BSE. The stock listed at Rs 1,800 apiece, up a mere 0.84 per cent from the issue price of Rs 1,785.

The public issue marked a significant milestone for the NSE, whose listing plans had remained stalled for nearly a decade amid regulatory hurdles, including those linked to the co-location controversy.

"Often there is a lot of debate whether a public utility like an exchange should get listed. Whether it carries an inherent tension of competition between what are the public interests and what are the stakeholders' interests. While at a superficial level there may appear to be some compe-



NSE Chairperson Srinivas Injeti

tion, it is our belief that if we look deeper, there is a complete convergence between the two," Injeti said at the listing ceremony.

He said NSE has a dual role -- a regulatory duty to maintain market integrity and protect public interests, and the responsibility as a business entity to promote its interests. "It is important for the entity to focus on its financial performance, to give returns to our shareholders. But it is very clear that if two lines intersect, if two duties intersect, the former will have an overriding advantage," Srinivas asserted.

"You can't do business without protecting public interests. There is no competition. ...If something is not good for the market, it is not good for you. So, guided by the philosophy of responsible business and sustainable business, I think we are just at the beginning of a take-off," he added.

The Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of NSE, the country's second-largest IPO, received nearly 6 times subscription on the

final day of bidding on Monday, led by strong demand from institutional buyers.

The offering was India's second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India's Rs 27,870-crore IPO in 2024. The IPO surpassed LIC's Rs 21,000 crore offering in 2022. "I think it is very clear that it is a large IPO. When we got the signing approval in January, we wanted to ensure that the IPO is launched as soon as possible. But later, as we went along, the market was not in the best of its shape," he said.

"What is most satisfying is that even though it was a large size issue, it was oversubscribed in all the categories. What is particularly satisfying is that the retail industrial investor (participation) also saw an oversubscription. I don't think any IPO had so much distribution and participation," he said.

NSE CEO, Ashish Kumar Chauhan, said "Broadly speaking we have been acting as a listed company practically for the last four-and-a-half years. We have been giving quarterly results, we have been giving material events as if we were listed all the time and we also had investor calls every quarter. So effectively, we were a listed company for all practical purposes and so in some ways, the additional compliances are very few compared to what we were doing already."

India-US trade pact 'done and dusted'; execution after India gets competitive advantage: Goyal

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 24

The trade pact between India and the US is "done and dusted" and will be executed once the United States gives India the right competitive advantage over its competitors in the American market, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday.

India and the US in February announced finalisation of the framework for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement (BTA). However, changes in the tariff landscape in the US have led to further negotiations on the pact.

He said that India has finalised nine free trade agreements, "and I include the US, which is almost done and dusted".

"We have to find the right comparable competitive advantage over our competitors, so that we can quickly execute the agreement," the minister added.

These remarks come ahead of Goyal's visit to the US for the G20 Trade Ministerial, to be held in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, from September 30 to October 1.

He will also hold a bilateral meeting with US Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Rail Coach Factory (RCF) Kapurthala is organising 'Swachhata Hi Seva Abhiyan-2026' from September 17 to October 2, 2026. The campaign was inaugurated on September 17 by RCF General Manager Ajay Nandan, who administered the cleanliness pledge to officers and employees.

'ONGC to continue Mahanadi drilling after gas find'

ANI NEWS

New Delhi, September 24

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) will continue drilling more wells following its gas discovery in the Mahanadi basin under the Samudra Manthan initiative, Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri said on Thursday, adding that India would maintain ethanol blending at 20 per cent while working to reduce green hydrogen costs.

Speaking to the media on the sidelines of the 13th Annual Forum 2026: India

3.0 - Engaging for Growth in a Disrupted World, Puri said the government was pursuing multiple avenues to reduce India's dependence on imported fossil fuels, including domestic oil and gas exploration, biofuels and green hydrogen.

Referring to ONGC's gas discovery and plans for further exploration, the minister said, "This is the beginning, this is the beginning. We are going to be digging more and more wells."

He said offshore exploration was a costly process and that drilling would

continue in areas considered commercially viable.

"We are going to be digging more and more wells. So whenever you get an area which is most viable in terms of because you know it's a costly process. But I'm very hopeful, and it's looking very good," Puri said.

The minister also referred to the government's wider offshore exploration programme, saying the Samudra Manthan initiative would enable the drilling of 150 wells over three years.

The Union Cabinet had approved the Samu-

dra Manthan National Offshore Exploration Scheme in July 2026, with an outlay of Rs 84,084 crore for implementation up to FY 2030-31.

On biofuels, Puri said India would maintain ethanol blending in petrol at 20 per cent as part of its strategy to reduce dependence on imported crude oil.

"So that will remain at 20%," he said, referring to the country's ethanol blending level.

India achieved its 20 per cent ethanol blending target in 2025, five years ahead of the original 2030 deadline.

IGL reports record gas sales of 9.39 mmscmd in FY2025-26

The company added 3.7 lakh domestic PNG connections & 70 CNG stations in FY26

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 24

Indraprastha Gas Ltd (IGL) reported record sales volumes in FY26, adding more than 3.7 lakh domestic piped natural gas (PNG) connections and 70 compressed natural gas (CNG) stations.

The company achieved record sales of 9.39 million standard cubic metres per day (mmscmd) during the year, Chairman Subhankar Sen told shareholders at IGL's 27th annual general meeting on Thursday.



IGL's gross turnover stood at Rs 17,785 crore in 2025-26, while profit after tax (PAT) was Rs

1,364 crore. Its net worth was Rs 9,987 crore as of March 31, 2026. Consolidated PAT, including con-

HIGHLIGHTS

» IGL's gross turnover stood at Rs 17,785 crore in FY26, while profit after tax was Rs 1,364 crore. Its net worth was Rs 9,987 crore as of March 31, 2026

» Consolidated PAT, including contributions from associates Central UP Gas Ltd and Maharashtra Natural Gas Ltd, was Rs 1,543 crore

tributions from associates Central UP Gas Ltd (CUGL) and Maharashtra Natural Gas Ltd (MNGL),

was Rs 1,543 crore.

The 70 new CNG stations took IGL's total network to 1,024 stations. The company also expanded its commercial and industrial customer base.

IGL is exploring renewable energy to replace conventional grid power and reduce carbon emissions. It has signed a joint venture agreement with Rajasthan Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd (RVUNL) for a 500 MWp greenfield solar power plant and floated a tender for a 200 MW solar plant in Rajasthan.

The company is also exploring the GOBARdhan initiative and acquisitions of stakes in existing city gas distribution companies.

As part of backward integration, IGL Genesis Technologies Ltd, a gas-meter manufacturing joint venture, has commenced commercial production.

IGL conducted more than 575 safety camps during the year. Its board recommended a final dividend of 75 per cent, or Rs 1.50/share, in addition to an interim dividend of 162.5 per cent, or Rs 3.25/share.



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice

No.29265631, Danapur, Dt. 21.09.2026
Sr. Divisional Manager, East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal www.iरेps.gov.in for the following work:

1. Name of work with its location: Supply of 5 watt VHF Digital Walkie Talkie Set without Keypad and without Display to Spec. No. RDSO/SPN/TC/107/2018 Ver. 2.0 or latest, SLNo.2.3 (b). 2. Tender No.: 29265631, 3. Bid Security (EMD) : Rs. 1,44,790.00, 4. Last Date & Time of Submission : Up to 14.00 hrs. on 09.11.2026, 5. Opening of tender : 14.00 hrs. on 09.11.2026, 6. Website particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen : www.iरेps.gov.in. 7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained : Sr. Divisional Manager, East Central Railway, Danapur. Note - Any corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.

Sr. DM,
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0986/DNR/Material/T/26-27/32

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jamal, S/o Shafiquiddin R/o H.No.2081, Kala Masjid, Sita Ram Bazar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.137/25 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jamal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jamal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jamal of FIR No.137/25 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08 (Central) Central District
Room No.272, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13556/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahdab, S/o Sh. Babu R/o H.No.558, Gali No.8, New Mustafabad, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.1129/2019 u/s 411 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahdab** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahdab** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shahdab of FIR No.1129/2019 u/s 411 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.12.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, (Central)
Room No. 138, First Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13428/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, **Sameer@Abbas S/o. Shamshad, R/o R-118/F, Gali No. 20, Braham Puri, Welcome, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 30566/2021, U/s: 379/34 IPC** registered at **P.S.: Welcome, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sameer@Abbas** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sameer@Abbas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant), Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Sameer@Abbas, FIR No. : 30566/2021, U/s: 379/34 IPC** registered at **P.S.: Welcome, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Karkardoom Court No.14 Shahdara, Delhi

DP/12877/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rajeev Kumar, M/s Shree Hanuman Traders Partner Mr. Rajeev LB-13, Laxmi Nagar, Gayatri Nagar, Near Mata Mandir First Gali, Line par Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh-244001** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI Act No.: 6570/2021, U/s: 138, 142 NI Act, P.S. Lahori Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rajeev Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rajeev Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rajeev Kumar of P.S. Lahori Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aradhana
JMFC NI Act-09, Room No. 208,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13469/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Yusuf S/o Md. Mustaq R/o Jhuggi No. 197 DCM Colony, Kishan Ganj Railway Station, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **DD No. 35A Dt.: 27.06.2023, U/S 103 DP Act, PS Sarai Rohilla Railway Station, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Yusuf** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Yusuf** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Yusuf** the said accused of **DD No. 35A Dt.: 27.06.2023, U/S 103 DP Act, PS Sarai Rohilla Railway Station, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11,
Central Distt., Court No.-138, 1st Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13445/RLY/2026
(Court Matter)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Open E-TENDER NOTICE

Open e-tender notice no. TRD/ OT/ 16/ Xover/ECR/26-27

E-tenders are invited from reputed contractors having proven experience, electrical license and sound financial standing supported by the valid documents for the work as per details given below:

Name of work with location : Provision of bi-directional line in diversion line/DDU by placing a X-over at EOC/DDU. Approx. Cost of the work: ₹1,56,39,347.38, Earnest Money/Bid Security to be deposited : ₹3,12,800/-, Last date and time for submission of tender : Upto 15.10.2026 on 15.00 hrs., Website particulars from where the details of e-tender can be obtained : www.iरेps.gov.in

Sr. Divnl. Elect. Engineer (TRD)/ ECR/PL Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/0986/DDU/TRD/T/26-27/28

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C/ 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **BIMLA DEVI W/o Krishan Verma R/o H. No. B-18, Gali No. 2, Hardev Nagar, Burari, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 578/2016 U/s 323/34/134 IPC, PS Burari, Distt. North, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Varrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **BIMLA DEVI** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **BIMLA DEVI** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **FIR No. 578/2016 U/s 323/34/134 IPC, PS Burari, Distt. North, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **27.10.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-09
Central Distt., Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13257/N/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH

JAL SHAKTI VIBHAG

"NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER"

The Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Division, Solan invites e-tender on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors/firms for the following work through e-tendering process:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Earnest money	Time of Completion.	Cost of form.	Last date of filing/ uploading the tender through e-tendering upto
1	"Construction of Sewerage Treatment Plant of 3.56 MLD capacity at Budhup under approved City Sanitation Action Plans (CSAP) under SBM (U) 2.0 for Municipal Corporation Solan (Sub Head:- Survey, Investigation, Design & Construction of 3.56 MLD capacity STP based on SBR technology as per latest CPHEEO manual with tertiary treatment so as to achieve discharge standard prescribed by NCT, C/o Lab building, Supply & installation of all lab equipments/instruments as per CPHEEO manual, C/o boundary walls, all kind of site development required i/c cutting and C/o Brest walls & Retaining walls etc. complete in all respects and trial run & testing period of 6 months after successful commissioning of the plant).	4, 53, 82,356/-	5,28,824 /-	Nine month.	7000/-	05.10.2026 upto 11:00 AM

The tender forms and other detailed can be obtained from website <https://jsv.hp.nic.in>.

Ro.No 3646/2026-2027

HIMSUCHNA AVAM JANSAMPARK

Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division, Solan

कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियंता लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी खण्ड बिलासपुर (छ.ग.)

पता :- पुराना कम्पाउंड सिटिंग, कक्ष क्र. 18, केनेशियर के सामने, Phone No. 07752-250593, Email ID - eebl-phe-cg@cg.gov.in

:: ई प्रोक्वोरमेंट द्वितीय निविदा सूचना::

जिला जल एवं स्वच्छता मिशन बिलासपुर की ओर कार्यपालन अभियंता एवं सदस्य सचिव, जिला जल एवं स्वच्छता मिशन बिलासपुर द्वारा एकीकृत पंजीयन व्यवस्था के अंतर्गत उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्नांकित कार्य हेतु प्रपत्र "अ" (प्रतिशत दर) ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :-

कार्य का नाम:- बिलासपुर जिले के जल जीवन मिशन में स्वीकृत एकल ग्राम योजना अंतर्गत पाईप लाईन विस्तार, उच्चस्तरिय जलगागर, घरेलू नल कनेक्शन एवं योजनांतर्गत शेष संपूर्ण कार्य। (संलग्न शेड्यूल अनुसार)

क्र.	निविदा क्र./ दिनांक /सिस्टम क्र.	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की लागत (रु. लाख में)	राशि (रु. में)	घरोहर (रु. में)
1	07/23.09.2026/199650 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम डिंपरापाड़ा एवं इन्धफोडवा (बरतोरी) विकासखण्ड बिहला	54.99	41500.00	
2	08/23.09.2026/199651 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम भिलास विकासखण्ड मसुरी	162.93	122500.00	
3	09/23.09.2026/199652 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम बिलीनी विकासखण्ड तखतपुर	57.05	43000.00	
4	10/23.09.2026/199653 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम बिलीनी विकासखण्ड तखतपुर	76.87	58000.00	
5	11/23.09.2026/199654 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम चूलघट विकासखण्ड तखतपुर	20.64	15500.00	
6	12/23.09.2026/199655 (2 nd Call)	ग्राम मोला (जा.) विकासखण्ड बिहला	29.12	22000.00	

ऑनलाईन निविदा की अन्य विवरण एवं विस्तृत जानकारी छ.ग. ज्ञान लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी विभाग के ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट वेबसाइट <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> दिनांक 29.09.2026 सुबह 11:00 बजे से तथा दिनांक 13.10.2026 सप्ताह 17:30 बजे तक बीड डाले जा सकते हैं एवं अन्य विवरण कार्यालयीन समय पर लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी खण्ड बिलासपुर (छ.ग.) में देखे जा सकते हैं।

कार्यपालन अभियंता
लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी खंड
बिलासपुर (छ.ग.)

G 262703499/2

ICI Home Finance

Corporate Office: ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, ICICI HFC Tower, Andheri - Kurla Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai- 400059, India.
Branch Office: Shop No 9, Ground Floor, GKs Palace, Ayub Khan- Choupole Road 63-64, Civil Lines, Bareilly- 243001
Notice for sale of immovable assets through Private Treaty

Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets through Private Treaty under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(B) r/w Rule 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

ICI Home Finance Company Limited (ICI HFC) conducted several e-Auctions for the sale of the mortgaged property mentioned below, however, all such e-Auctions failed. Now, an interested buyer has approached ICICI HFC with an offer to purchase Reserve Price (Please refer below table). Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below-described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd., will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is", by way of Private Treaty as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Legal Heirs. Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price/ Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of Auction	One Day Before Auction Date	Sarfaesi Stage
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)	(I)
1.	Rajesh Kashyap (Borrower) Priti (Co-Borrowers) Lan No. LHBAR00001348314/ LHBAR00001348449	Part of Plot at Khata No. 00006 bearing Khata No. 669/2 at Village Banka Sathura Tehsil and District Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh- 243001	Rs. 18,22,832/- Sep 18, 2026	Rs. 8,00,000/- Sep 18, 2026	October 05, 2026 11:00 AM To 03:00 PM	October 12, 2026 02:00 PM To 03:00 PM	October 09, 2026 before 04:00 PM	Physical Possession
2.	Nilesh Verma (Borrower) Harsh Verma (Co-Borrowers) Lan No. LHBAR00001485479/ LHBAR00001485484	House No 27 Kharsa No 1058 Village Biharmora Nagla (ambika Vihar Phase 3) Tehsil and Distt Bareilly 1 Bareilly Uttar Pradesh 243001	Rs. 25,718/- Sep 18, 2026	Rs. 25,000/- Sep 18, 2026	October 05, 2026 11:00 AM To 03:00 PM	October 12, 2026 02:00 PM To 03:00 PM	October 09, 2026 before 04:00 PM	Physical Possession

The online auction will be conducted on website (URL Link- <https://BidDeal.in>) of our auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) RTGS/ Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 09, 2026 before 04:00 PM. The Prospective Bidder(s) must also submit a signed copy of the Registration Form & Bid Terms and Conditions form at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 09, 2026 before 05:00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit Demand Draft (DD) should be from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favor of "ICI Home Finance Company Ltd. - Auction" payable at the branch office address mentioned on top of the article.

The general public is requested to submit their bids higher than the amount being offered by the interested buyer mentioned above. It is hereby informed that in case no bids higher than the amount being offered by the aforementioned interested buyer is received by ICICI HFC, the mortgaged property shall be sold to the said interested buyer as per Rule 8(B) r/w Rule 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the sale or submission of bids, kindly contact ICICI Home Finance Company Limited on 9920807300

The Authorized Officer reserves the right to reject the bids without furnishing any further reasons.

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit <https://www.icicifhc.com>

Date: September 25, 2026
Authorized Officer, "ICI Home Finance Company Limited"
CIN Number:- U65922MH1999PLC120106

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, North Central Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work:

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGGS-GSU-2026-07 **Approx Cost (Rs.):** 126028380.55

Description of work: Provision of additional goods line with increase in existing goods wharf at New Lalitpur town station of Jhansi Division, North Central Railway.

Earnest Money (Rs.): 2520600.00 **Date of closing Tender:** 21.10.2026

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 month

Tender online can be submitted up to 10:30 hrs. on 21.10.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.iरेps.gov.in 2163/26(K)

f North central railways **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in** **@CPNCR**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: 8220282027 Dated: 22.09.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works upto 13:30 hrs, on 21.10.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.: 175
Name of Works: Upgradation of Lighting arrangements and provision of Pathway at GMC Yard Kanpur under ADEN/Line/CNB.	
Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.): ₹ 1,84,27,211.76	Completion Period: 12 Months
Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 3,68,600.00	Date of Opening of Tender: 21.10.2026
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Any Civil Engineering work.	
S.No.: 2	Tender No.: 176
Name of Works: Track work in connection with Enhancement of freight stock examination & maintenance facilities at GMC (Phase-I) under ADEN/Line/CNB.	
Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.): ₹ 2,18,56,671.88	Completion Period: 12 Months
Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 4,37,100.00	Date of Opening of Tender: 21.10.2026
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Any P Way Work.	

Note: (1) Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 21.10.2026. (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.iरेps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e 21.10.2026.

f North central railways **@CPNCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**

ICI Home Finance

Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051

Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059

Branch Address: 308A, 308B, 327A & 327B, 3rd Floor, DGE Block, Plot No.11, Golden-I, Greater Noida West, U.P-201301 Branch Address: 2nd floor, Vishwakarma Complex, Plot No 17/18, Behind Yashoda Hospital, Kaushambi, Ghaziabad- 201010 Branch Address: 3rd floor, 302-303, Pearl Bert Heights-L, Netaji Subhash Place, Wazirpur, Pitampura, Delhi - 110034 Branch Address: 1st floor, XVI / 10200, 13/30 Beadon Pura, Padam Singh Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005, Branch Address: A-354, Sector-19, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 Branch Address: 1st Floor, 36, Defence enclave, Vikas marg, East Delhi - 110092 Branch Address: 307/1, 1st floor, Bishnoi Tower, Mangal Pandey Nagar, Opposite Apex Tower, Meerut - 250004 Branch Address: 6th Floor, Unit No.616, A, B, C and 617 A-B-C-D, Universal Trade Tower, Sector -49, Gurgaon, Haryana-122018 Branch Address: 2nd Floor, SCO-319, Sec -29, Gurgaon, Haryana- 122001

The following borrower/s have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest of the loans facility obtained by them from ICICI Home Finance Company Limited ("ICI HFC") and the loans have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA). A notice was issued to them under Section 13 (2) of Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act-2002 on their last known addresses, however it was not served and hence they are hereby notified by way of this public notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Property Address of Secured Asset/ Asset to be Enforced	Date of Notice Sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Tanveer, (Borrower), Amrish Tiwari (Co-Borrower), Blubucks Asset Private Limited (Co-Borrower), Haseeba Khatun (Co-Borrower), House No -277 C - Block Phase -2 Inder Enclave, Kirti Suleman Nagar Delhi 110086, LHGN00001695836	Entire Second Floor(Without Roof/ Terrace Rights), House No. F-282, Block-F, Situated At Vikaspuri, New Delhi-110018 Area Measuring 72 Sq. Mtrs, With Lift And ¼Th Separate Car Parking Space Near Staircase, Bounded By- North By: Path 5 Meters, South By: S/Lane, East By: Plot No. 281, West By: Road 9 Meters.	04-09-2026 Rs. 76,49,239/-	30-08-2026
2.	Anurag Nagpal (Borrower), Rekha Rani (Co-Borrower), A 74 Back Side Gaurav Dharm Kanta, Naraina Phase 1 Naraina Village, Naraina Phase 1, Naraina Village Delhi 110028, LHGH20001600820	Entire Third Floor (Without Roof Rights), Block-A, Property Bearing No. 115, Out Of Kharsa No. 182/25/26/22/23/31, Situated In The Area Of Village Of Bharola, Colony Known As Majlis Park, Delhi-110033 Area Measuring 180 Sq. Yrds.I.E. 150.50 Sq.Mtrs, Alongwith ¼ Undivided Share In Stilt Parking On Ground Floor, Bounded By- North By: Lane 10', South By: Road 25', East By: Plot No.116, West By: Plot No. 114.	04-09-2026 Rs. 1,44,43,984/-	30-01-2026
3.	Anurag Nagpal (Borrower), Rekha Rani (Co-Borrower), A 74 Back Side Gaurav Dharm Kanta, Naraina Phase 1 Naraina Village, Naraina Phase 1, Naraina Village Delhi 110028, LHGH20001600936	Entire Third Floor (Without Roof Rights), Block-A, Property Bearing No. 115, Out Of Kharsa No. 182/25/26/22/23/31, Situated In The Area Of Village Of Bharola, Colony Known As Majlis Park, Delhi-110033 Area Measuring 180 Sq. Yrds.I.E. 150.50 Sq.Mtrs, Alongwith ¼ Undivided Share In Stilt Parking On Ground Floor, Bounded By- North By: Lane 10', South By: Road 25', East By: Plot No.116, West By: Plot No. 114.	04-09-2026 Rs. 3,50,012.37/-	30-01-2026
4.	Muni Ram (Borrower), Manju Devi (Co-Borrower), H No 183 liird Floor, Pkt 16 Sector 24 Rohini Delhi, Delhi Delhi 110042 Delhi, LHPTU00001388662	Entire 3rd Floor (With Roof And Above Rights), Property Bearing No.183, Pocket-16, Sector-24, Rohini Residential Scheme, Rohini, Delhi-110085 Area 60 Sq. Mtrs, Including Common Rights To Use The Stairs Ground To Top Floor With ¼ Proportionate Rights Of The Area Bounded By- North By: Plot No-172, South By: Entry, East By: Plot No-184, West By: Plot No-182.	12-09-2026 Rs. 26,90,317/-	03-09-2026
5.	Anupam Avasthi (Borrower), Kamini Avasthi (Co-Borrower), 18/13B First Floor Near Post Office Tilak Nagar West Delhi Delhi 110018 Delhi, LHDKB00001337686	Third Floor (Front Side Portion), With Roof/ Terrace Rights, Property No. S-1/33, Built On Plot No.47, Out Of Kharsa No.1, Etc /04, Situated In The Village Nagli Jalib And The Colony Known As Old Mahabir Nagar, New Delhi-110018, Area 100 Sq. Yrds.(Size 30'X 30') Without Right Plot 47 Vill Nagli Jalib Mahabir Nagar- Delhi 110018 Delhi Bounded By- North By: Other Property, South By: Other Property, East By: Other Unit Of Said Property, West By: Gali.	12-09-2026 Rs. 31,27,965/-	03-09-2026
6.	Ashwani Kamboj (Borrower), Kuber Trading Company (Co-Borrower), Rimpi, (Co-Borrower), Flat No 1004 10Th Floor Tower Nob2 Kji, Heights Bahadurgarh Jhajjar Heights Bahadurgarh Jhajjar Heights Bahadurgarh 124507 Haryana, LHNOD00001605486	Entire Ground Floor (Without Roof Rights), Out Of Kharsa No. 106/11, Khata No. 132/183, Situated Under The Extended Abadi Of Village Pooh Kadan, Delhi-110086, Area 183.33 Sq.Yds, Bounded By- North By: Main Khanjwala Road, South By: Other Property, East By: Bank Of Baroda Building, West By: Property Of Nahinder Singh/Axis Bank.	12-09-2026 Rs. 1,38,16,428/-	08-09-2026
7.	Ved Pal Singh (Now Deceased), Through Its All Known And Unknown, Dead Heirs (Borrower), Nitin Kumar (Being Legal Heir And Co-Borrower) (Co-Borrower), Fl No 6 B Lig Pocket A1 Mayur Vihar Phase Iii East Delhi Delhi 110096 Delhi, LHGH200001606971	Freehold Flat No. 5-D, On First Floor, Pocket A- Through Its All Known And Unknown, Dead Heirs (Borrower), Nitin Kumar (Being Legal Heir And Co-Borrower) (Co-Borrower), Fl No 6 B Lig Pocket A1 Mayur Vihar Phase Iii East Delhi Delhi 110096 Delhi, LHGH200001606971	12-09-2026 Rs. 19,26,487.71/-	08-09-2026
8.	Pradip Singh (Borrower), Raghendra Pratap Singh (Guarantor), House No C 282 Sector 100 Noida Noida 201301 Uttar Pradesh, LHDLX00001461970	Property Bearing No.83/14, Out Of Kharsa No. 83/4, Etc /14, Situated In The Village Hastal, In The Abadi Colony Known As Pratap Enclave Near Kharsa No. 83/4, Etc /14, Situated In The Revenue Estate Of Village Palom, Delhi-110059 Area Measuring 94.47 Sq. Mtrs, I.E. 113 Sq. Yrds, Approx. Bounded By- North By: Road 15 Feet Wide, South By: Gali 6 Feet Wide, East By: Plot Of Others, West By: Plot Of Others.	12-09-2026 Rs. 35,21,248/-	03-09-2026
9.	Singhvahini Infraprojects Private Limited (Borrower), Pradip Singh (Co-Borrower), Raghvender Pratap Singh (Co-Borrower), J 47 Sector 18 Noida Gautam Budhaha Nagar Uttar Pradesh, Residence Card Office, Uttar pradesh Noida Noida 201303 Uttar Pradesh, LHGH200001587878	Freehold Residential Plot, Situated In Kharsa No.732, Village Gautam Khadar, Pargana And Tehsil Dadri, Salarpur Budh Nagar-201307 (U.P.) Measuring 1000 Sq. Mtrs, Bounded By- North By: Other Plot, South By: Rasta 35 Ft, East By: Other Plot, West By: Other Plot.	12-09-2026 Rs. 3,00,94,856/-	03-09-2026
10.	Gourav Soni (Borrower), Kanti Soni (Co-Borrower), Kanpur Belly Transport Company Main Road, Tawar Wali Building Meerut Meerut 250002 Uttar Pradesh, LHMRT00001515429	Flat No.05, Second Floor, Plot No.5, Kharsa No. 83 And 84, Akasapuram Colony, Revenue Village Mohkampur, Pargana, Tehsil And Distt, Meerut-250001 Uttar Pradesh, Area 55.39 Sq. Mtrs, Bounded By- North By: 39 Ft 9 Inch Then Flat No 4, South By: 39 Ft 9 Inch Then Flat No 6, East By: 15 Ft Then Property Of Other, West By: 15 Ft Wide Then 16 Ft Wide Road.	12-09-2026 Rs. 7,57,432.6/-	03-09-2026
11.	Gourav Soni (Borrower), Kanti Soni (Co-Borrower), Kanpur Belly Transport Company Main Road, Tawar Wali Building Meerut Meerut 250002 Uttar Pradesh, LHMRT00001602779	Flat No.05, Second Floor, Plot No.5, Kharsa No. 83 And 84, Akasapuram Colony, Revenue Village Mohkampur, Pargana, Tehsil And Distt, Meerut-250001 Uttar Pradesh, Area 55.39 Sq. Mtrs, Bounded By- North By: 39 Ft 9 Inch Then Flat No 4, South By: 39 Ft 9 Inch Then Flat No 6, East By: 15 Ft Then Property Of Other, West By: 15 Ft Wide Then 16 Ft Wide Road.	12-09-2026 Rs. 3,41,342/-	03-09-2026
12.	Vijandra Kumar (Borrower), Beena, (Co-Borrower), Shyana Kachari, Shyana Shyana Bulandshahar, Bulandshahar Bulandshahar 203001 Uttar Pradesh, LHMRT00001522295	A Residential House, Nagar Nigum No.745/U, Kharsa No.1264/L, Situated In New Govindpuri, Village Naglatashi Kasampur, Pargana, Tehsil And Distt, Meerut-250001 Uttar Pradesh, Area 100 Sq. Mtrs, OR 119.60 Sq. Yrds, Bounded By- North By: 41.25 Ft Then Araji Mukir, South By: 26.1 Ft Then Araji Mukir Land, West By: 26.1 Ft Then Araji Mukir Land Of Moya.</		

ALL BSE SECTORAL INDICES ENDED LOWER

Sensex slumps 1,248 points on selling in financial, metal, auto and oil stocks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 24

Stock markets tumbled on Thursday with the benchmark index Sensex tanking nearly 1,248 points to settle at an over three-month low due to across-the-board selling, led by financials, metal, auto and oil shares amid a spike in crude oil prices and surging US bond yields.

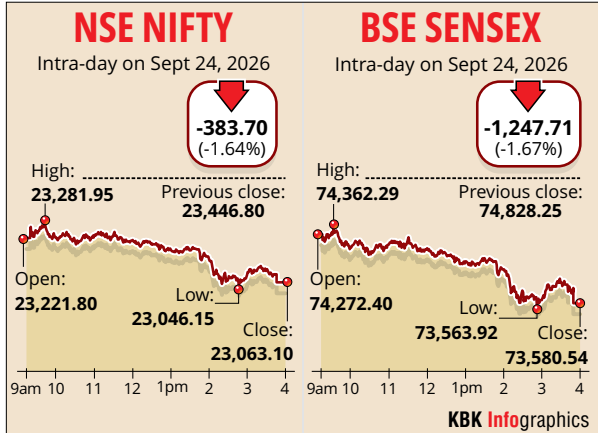
The 30-share BSE Sensex tanked 1,247.71 points, or 1.67 per cent, to settle near the day's low levels at 73,580.54, the lowest closing level since June 8.

During the day, it plummeted 383.70 points, or 1.68 per cent, to 73,563.92.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 383.70 points, or 1.64 per cent, to end at a more than five-month low of 23,063.10.

As many as 47 Nifty constituents ended lower and three advanced.

Analysts said markets were weighed down by heavy selling in financial shares such as Axis Bank, Bajaj Finance and HDFC Bank after insurance reg-



KEY POINTS

» The BSE MidCap Select index tanked 3.12 per cent and SmallCap Select index was down 1.19 per cent

» A total of 2,884 stocks declined, 1,473 advanced & 216 remained unchanged on the BSE. As many as 47 Nifty constituents ended lower and three advanced

» FIIs bought equities worth ₹1,617.45 cr on Wednesday

ulator IRDAI proposed changes to the insurance distribution framework, including lower Expenses of Management limits and tighter controls on commissions.

Global factors such as high US bond yields and a spike in crude oil prices also dented the market sentiment, they added.

Among Sensex shares, Bajaj Finance dropped the most by 5.47 per cent, Axis Bank declined 4.67 per cent, Bajaj Finserv 4.06 per cent, InterGlobe Aviation 2.78 per cent, Trent 2.75 per cent, and Mahindra & Mahindra 2.31 per cent.

NTPC ended unchanged.

“On the sectoral front, banking and financials came under significant pressure after IRDAI proposed changes to the insurance distribution framework, including lower Expenses of Management limits and tighter controls on commissions. The proposals raised concerns about the earnings and distribution economics of insurers and other related financial intermediaries,” Ajit Mishra, SVP-research, Religare Broking, said.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped

2.36 per cent to \$105.4 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select index tanked 3.12 per cent and SmallCap Select index was down 1.19 per cent.

All BSE sectoral indices ended lower. MidSmall Private Banks dropped 2.81 per cent, Housing Finance 2.56 per cent, Financial Services 2.33 per cent, Insurance 2.20 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 2.13 per cent, Bankex 1.88 per cent, Private Banks index 1.85 per cent, Top 10 Banks 1.74 per cent, Metal 1.65 per cent and Services 1.43 per cent. A total of 2,884

stocks declined, while 1,473 advanced and 216 remained unchanged on the BSE.

“The domestic decline was amplified by the IRDAI consultation paper proposing tighter limits on insurance commissions, distribution expenses and loan-linked insurance practices. The potential pressure on bancassurance fees triggered heavy selling across insurers, distribution platforms and exposed banks and NBFCs, pushing Bank Nifty below 56,000 and extending the damage to the broader benchmarks,” Hariselman Radhakrishnan, Founder & CEO of HST Wealth, a Research Analyst firm, said.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 1,617.45 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

On Wednesday, the Sensex climbed 299.17 points, or 0.40 per cent, to settle at 74,828.25. The Nifty was up 117.80 points, or 0.50 per cent, to end at 23,446.80.

ADB lifts India's economic growth forecast to 7% for current fiscal

ANI NEWS

New Delhi, September 24

The Asian Development Bank (ADB) has raised its growth forecast for India to 7 per cent for FY2026-27 from 6.6 per cent earlier, while projecting the economy to expand 7.1 per cent in FY2027-28, citing stronger-than-expected growth, resilient domestic demand and sustained investment.

The upgrade, announced in its Asian Development Outlook September 2026, follows 7.8 per cent year-on-year GDP growth in the first quarter of FY2026-27, supported by robust investment demand, resilient consumption and growth in manufacturing and services, ADB said.

ADB has, however, lowered its FY2027-28 growth forecast from 7.3 per cent to 7.1 per cent, largely due to the stronger base created by the higher growth expected in FY2026-27. It expects domestic demand to remain the main driver of growth in both years, supported by robust tax collections, low interest rates, rising household incomes and the anticipated revision of government salaries and pensions in FY2027-28.



“Despite supply disruptions and high commodity prices, India's economy continues to demonstrate resilience, supported by strong infrastructure spending and growth-supporting fiscal and monetary policies,” ADB Country Director for India Mio Oka said.

She added that continued strength in services, including AI-related investments, along with improvements in agricultural productivity and steady manufacturing growth, would help sustain the growth momentum.

Public spending remains an important support for growth, with central government capital expenditure rising 29.9 per cent in the first quarter of FY2026-27 and remaining on track to meet its annual target of 11.5 per cent.

ADB also expects private investment to pick up, supported by improvements in logistics infra-

structure, regulatory reforms and a strong pipeline of projects.

On inflation, ADB lowered its FY2026-27 forecast to 5 per cent from 5.2 per cent, while retaining its FY2027-28 projection at 4 per cent. It said inflation could remain within the Reserve Bank of India's target range, although the central bank may consider raising the repo rate if price pressures intensify.

ADB also flagged prolonged geopolitical uncertainty and weather disruptions linked to El Niño as risks to future growth, which could affect agricultural output and raise industrial input costs. However, it expects services and construction to remain robust through FY2026-27 and FY2027-28.

The ADB's upgrade comes alongside higher growth forecasts from Fitch Ratings and S&P Global. Fitch has raised its FY2026-27 projection to 6.9 per cent from 6.4 per cent, while S&P Global has increased its forecast to 7 per cent from 6.6 per cent, citing strong consumption and industrial activity. Both, however, expect growth to moderate in the second half of the fiscal year.

Rupee tanks 26 paise to close at 95.99 against US dollar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, September 24

The rupee weakened by 26 paise to settle at 95.99 against the US dollar on Thursday, dragged by a surge in crude oil prices and a strong greenback amid geopolitical uncertainties.

According to forex traders, the domestic currency was also weighed down by heavy selling in domestic equity markets as investors moved toward risk aversion, adding strength to the dollar, even as rising inflation concerns pushed US bond yields higher.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.84 and touched the intraday low of 95.99 against the American currency.

The unit finally ended the session at 95.99 against the greenback, down by 26 paise from its previous closing level.

The rupee closed 11 paise lower at 95.73 against the US dollar on Wednesday, a day after appreciating by 16 paise.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, traded at 100.99, up 0.18 per cent.

FIIs purchased equities worth Rs 1,617.45 crore on a net basis on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

West Bengal allots land to Websol for 4 GW solar cell, module facility

MPOST BUREAU

Kolkata, September 24

Websol Energy System Ltd said the West Bengal government has allotted about 54.20 acres at Falta Industrial Park, Kolkata, for its planned greenfield solar manufacturing facility.

The proposed facility will have 4 GW each of solar cell and module manufacturing capacity, to be developed in two phases of 2 GW each.

Websol said the land allotment followed an evaluation of locations near its existing manufacturing operations at the Falta Special Economic Zone. The expansion in West Bengal will leverage its more than

THE PROPOSED FACILITY WILL HAVE 4 GW EACH OF SOLAR CELL & MODULE MANUFACTURING CAPACITY, TO BE DEVELOPED IN TWO PHASES OF 2 GW EACH

three decades of operating experience in the state, including access to skilled manpower, supplier relationships and an established local ecosystem.

The facility will create a larger integrated manufacturing base for Websol in eastern India as domestic solar manufacturing capacity expands to meet

rising renewable energy requirements.

Sohan Lal Agarwal, Chairman and Managing Director, Websol Energy System Ltd, said the land allotment marked “the next phase of a journey that began more than three decades ago in West Bengal” and would allow the company to build at a significantly larger scale.

Sanjana Khaitan, Executive Director, Websol Energy System Ltd, said the focus would now be on execution, from land allotment to construction, commissioning and utilisation, with growth measured by how efficiently capacity translates into production, delivery and revenue.

L&T ships 64,000 MT modules to Australia

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 24

L&T has completed one of its largest modular fabrication assignments for Australia, building and shipping 110 process and pipe-rack modules weighing nearly 64,000 MT under Project CERES over 36 months.

The company built the modules for Australia's largest urea manufacturing plant, with a capacity of 2.3 MTPA, at its Kattupalli Fabrication Facility near Chennai. The modules were shipped to Australia across



23 voyages.

The project demonstrates India's capability to engineer, fabricate and export mega-scale industrial assets for global projects, highlighting the potential of Indian engineering and manufacturing in delivering complex infrastructure overseas.

India's power sector needs integrated planning: Power Secy

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 24

India's power sector is entering a fundamentally different phase of growth that requires generation, transmission, storage and distribution to be planned together, Union Power Secretary Pankaj Agarwal said on Thursday.

India's installed capacity is expected to cross 530 GW by the end of this fiscal year, according to Vipul Tuli, Chair of FICCI's RE CEOs Committee.

BSES Rajdhani Power CEO Abhishek Ranjan said renewable capacity

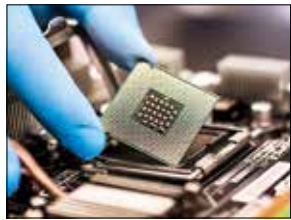
PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 24

The government has started a consultation process to explore the development of indigenous power semiconductors and modules for power grids.

The Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY), along with the Power Ministry and Powergrid, on Thursday invited industry players for a pre-request for proposal stakeholder consultation to gather input before issuing the final proposal.

“Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY), Ministry of Power and Powergrid invite you for a Pre-RFP



Stakeholder Consultation for the indigenous design, development, qualification and supply of SiC MOSFET-based power modules for VSC-HVDC,” MeitY said in a social media post.

VSC-HVDC (Voltage-Sourced Converter High-Voltage Direct Current) is an advanced power transmission technology that uses semiconductors to convert electricity waves

according to the requirements of all electrical appliances across homes, offices and industries.

According to details shared by MeitY on its website, the initiative aims to build domestic capability across the power semiconductor value chain - device design, module engineering, fabrication, packaging, assembly, testing, qualification and system integration.

Interested entities can send their queries and suggestions by October 8 and the consultation is scheduled to be held on October 14.

The objective of the government is to reduce

dependence on imported technology for strategic grid applications.

“Around 13,000 modules committed for pilot procurement, so there is an assured demand waiting,” the social media post said.

Indian companies, including startups and MSMEs, individually or in consortia of up to 4 partners, can apply for the RFP. “Academia, national labs and R&D institutions can join as partners,” MeitY said.

Electricity grids in the country, classified as critical infrastructure, are highly dependent on imported equipment.

NBCC hands over two Bharat Business Park towers to SBER

SBER India plans to establish a Russian Business Centre in New Delhi to support Russian cos operating in India

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 24

NBCC (India) Ltd on September 23 handed over the letter of allotment (LoA) and agreement to sale for two towers at Bharat Business Park (BBP), Sarojini Nagar, to SBER India, in one of the largest purchases of Indian office space by a foreign bank.

NBCC CMD KP Mahadevaswamy handed over the documents to SBER India Deputy Managing Director Igor Shishkin at the company's corporate headquarters in New



Delhi.

The two towers com-

prise about 5.17 lakh sq ft of super built-up area and

HIGHLIGHTS

» SBER Bank acquired them through a competitive e-auction in April 2026, becoming the largest single buyer at the project

» NBCC has sold all eight towers of BBP, spanning about 23.44 lakh sq ft, for around Rs 10,000 crore.

» Other buyers include IRCTC, Government e-Marketplace, BPCL, RVNL & National Land Monetization Corporation

have a sale value of more than Rs 2,000 crore.

SBER Bank acquired them through a competitive e-auction in April 2026, becoming the largest single buyer at the project.

SBER India plans to establish a Russian Business Centre in New Delhi to support Russian companies operating in India with banking, legal, tax and audit services.

NBCC has sold all eight towers of BBP, spanning about 23.44 lakh sq ft, for around Rs 10,000 crore.

The project is expected to be completed in 2028. Other buyers include

IRCTC, Government e-Marketplace, BPCL, RVNL and National Land Monetization Corporation.

Mahadevaswamy said SBER India's decision “is a strong endorsement of NBCC's execution capability and of Delhi as a destination for global business”.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the eight towers on March 8, 2026. The early sale of BBP is expected to support funding for completion of the 7 GPRA redevelopment project.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



The MoA for implementation of grid-connected rooftop solar PV systems across 76 ICAR institutes was signed by Jaspal Singh Kushwaha, GM, Renewable Division, RECPDCL and Kumar Rajesh, Director (GAC), ICAR, in the presence of Dr. M L Jat, Secretary, DARE & DG, ICAR; Sandeep Sarkar, Additional Secretary, DARE & Financial Advisor, ICAR; Gyanendra D Tripathi, Additional Secretary, DARE & Secretary, ICAR; and Prince Dhawan, IAS, CEO, RECPDCL.

Briefs

Babar plays 1st domestic red ball game

KARACHI: Pakistan Test captain Babar Azam on Thursday made his first appearance in the country's domestic first class competition after more than six years.

Babar is representing the Oil and Gas Development team in the third round of the President's Cup which began on Thursday.

Babar's name featured in the OGDCL's teamsheet for the match against KRL although he is not captaining the side. Babar's last first class appearance was back in December 2019.

Pranati finishes 6th in vault final

NAGOYA: India's Pranati Nayak finished at the sixth spot in eight-women vault final in Artistic gymnastics event at the Asian Games here on Thursday.

The 31-year-old, the lone gymnast from India at the quadrennial event, scored identical 12.900 on her first and second vault to aggregate 13.100 with a 0.20 bonus added to her total.

The Indian, who had recovered from a leg injury to make it to the Games, went for a difficulty score of 4.4 and execution score of 8.500 in both her vaults. Korea's Yeo Seojeong (14.100) won the gold, while North Korea's An Chang Ok (13.033) and Du Siyu (12.800) claimed the silver and bronze medals respectively.

Bhavani, Shreya bow out in fencing

NAGOYA: India's fencing campaign at the Asian Games ended without a medal as C A Bhavani Devi and Shreya Gupta were eliminated in the women's individual sabre event here on Thursday.

Bhavani, India's first fencer to compete at the Olympics, advanced to the round of 16 after defeating Mongolia's Oulen Tugsjargan 15-8 in the round of 32. However, the 32-year-old Indian ran into a tough opponent in China's Rao Xueyi and went down 5-15 in the pre-quarterfinals. Rao took control early and led 8-2 at the end.

SEEMA SECURES SURPRISE BRONZE

India wins 3rd straight medal in mixed 4x400m relay with silver

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 24

India's mixed 4x400m relay team won its third consecutive Asian Games medal by securing a silver, while Seema fetched a surprise bronze in the women's 10,000m race as the country's athletics campaign began on a strong note here on Thursday.

The quartet of TS Manu, MR Poovamma, Vishal TK and Vithya Ramraj clocked 3 minute 14.46 seconds to finish behind Bahrain who took the gold with a Games record time of 3:12.87.

The result of the relay race was, however, kept unofficial for a while due to UAE lodging a protest. Later, UAE's disqualification was confirmed and the result was made official.

Earlier in the morning, India qualified for the final of the mixed 4x400m relay after finishing second in Heat 2. India had a gold in the 2018 edition, when the event was introduced, and clinched a silver in the last Asian Games.

"We were expecting a gold. But of course, Bahrain, we were expecting a tough fight. But we all ran really good," Poovamma said later. "So, in the women's 400 relay, we want to win a gold, change the colour of the medal."

It was in the women's 10,000m race that India opened the medal account in the Asian Games through the 25-year-old Seema who clocked 32 minute 50.05 seconds to finish third behind Winfred Yavi



India's T S Manu, M R Poovamma, Vithya Ramraj, and T K Vishal celebrate after winning the silver medal in the 4x400m mixed relay event during the Asian Games, in Nagoya on Thursday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The result of the relay race was, however, kept unofficial for a while due to UAE lodging a protest
- » India had a gold in the 2018 edition, when the event was introduced, and clinched a silver in the last Asian Games

(32:39.18) of Bahrain and Nozomi Tanaka (32:41.54) of Japan. Prime Minister

Narendra Modi tweeted, "Proud of Seema on winning the Bronze Medal in

the Women's 10,000m at the Asian Games! Congrats to her.

"Her determined performance has brought India a medal in this event after many years. A wonderful achievement that reflects endurance, discipline and years of hard work. Wishing her many more successes in the times ahead."

Indian men, women Kabaddi teams top group to enter semis

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 24

Defending champions India stormed into the men's and women's kabaddi semi-finals with resounding wins over Chinese Taipei and Japan in their Group A fixtures here on Thursday.

While the Indian men defeated Chinese Taipei 37-21 win over Chinese Taipei in their final Group A fixture, the Indian women beat hosts Japan 50-25 to top their group.

The victory was Indian men's fourth consecutive in the group stage, where the side earlier defeated South Korea, Japan and Bangladesh to sign off

unbeaten and be assured of at least a bronze.

India dominated from the outset, taking a 23-11 lead at half-time before maintaining their advantage in the second half, which they won 14-10.

India collected 28 points through successful raids, three bonus points and six points from all-outs.

Since kabaddi became an Asiad sport in 1990, the Indian men's team has won nine medals, including eight gold, maintaining unparalleled dominance in the sport.

The record streak of golds was only disrupted in 2018 when the side ended with a bronze.

India beat Korea 8-2 in Hockey

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kakamigahara, Sept 24

In-form striker Dilpreet Singh fired a hat-trick to hand the Indian men's hockey team a comfortable 8-2 win over Korea and all but assure its place in the semi-final of the Asian Games here on Thursday.

It was India's third consecutive win, keeping them at the top of pool A. India had earlier thrashed Indonesia 13-1 and Sri Lanka 16-1 in their opening two pool matches.

Dilpreet (10th, 26th, 32nd minutes) continued his impressive form and scored three fine field goals, while Abhishek (15th, 38th) struck a brace.

Boxer Parveen advances; Sakshi bows out, injured Sumit also exits

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 24

Indian boxer Parveen progressed to the quarterfinals of women's 65kg after getting a walkover from Tajikistan's Malika Nozimova but it was curtains for compatriots Sakshi Chaudhary (51kg) and Sumit (70kg) at the Asian Games here on Thursday.

Parveen, who had served a WADA suspension for whereabouts clause failure which cost her an Asian Games bronze medal and an Olympic quota, had finished at the quarterfinal stage at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games,



her first major competition in a new weight category of 65kg. Earlier, Sakshi bowed out of the Asian Games following a 2-3 pre-quarterfinal loss to Kazakhstan's Alua Balkibekova in the women's 51kg category.

The 26-year-old from Haryana, who won gold in the Glasgow Common-

wealth Games, struggled to connect her punches as Balkibekova stayed ahead across all three rounds to secure her place in the quarterfinals. Sakshi attempted combinations but the Kazakh boxer used her right hook effectively and appeared to have the edge, leading 3-2 after the opening round.

Chhattisgarh emerges a premier sports destination

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Raipur, September 24

Chhattisgarh has been rapidly emerging as a sports destination in the country, with the state government making efforts to regularly host major sporting events and providing athletes with better platforms to showcase their talent.

The approach gained a national platform with the Khelo India Tribal Games 2026. Held across Raipur, Jagdalpur and Surguja, the inaugural event was dedicated exclusively to tribal athletes and featured athletics, football, hockey, weightlifting, archery, swimming and wrestling, with kabaddi and mallakhamb as demonstration sports. T

The men's 100-metre national record had been broken three times within two days, with sprinters Animesh Kujur, from Jashpur lowering it to 10.15 seconds.



Gyaneshwari Yadav of Rajnandgaon has emerged as a leading weightlifter. Her silver medal at the 2026 Commonwealth Games, achieved with a personal best.

Aakarshi Kashyap has represented India in badminton, while footballer Kiran Pisda and kabaddi player . Sanju Devi represented India at the 6th Women's Asian Kabaddi Championship in Iran, winning a gold medal and helping India secure qualification for the World Cup.

During the State Sports

Award Ceremony recently held in Raipur on National Sports Day, Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai said that his government is committed to taking Chhattisgarh's sporting talent to national and international platforms.

The Chief Minister presented State Sports Awards to 126 outstanding players and coaches. Cash incentives were also provided to 540 other players. Altogether, 666 players and coaches received awards and incentives amounting to Rs 1.74 crore.

Satnam-Salman duo wins India's maiden bronze in men's double sculls

The 2018 Games yielded three podium finishes, including one gold

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 24

Satnam Singh and Salman Khan's double sculls bronze turned out to be the saving grace as the embattled Indian rowing team produced one of the worst performances in the Asian Games history here on Thursday. The duo's bronze was India's first ever men's double sculls medal at the continental games.

Rowing competitions were introduced in the 1982 Asian Games, and India won the most medals in the 2010 Guangzhou and 2023 Hangzhou editions. India had won five medals in 2010, including one gold, three silver and one bronze. The number remained the same in 2023 but there was no gold in the tally as the rowers logged two silver and three bronze medals. The 2018 Games yielded three



Indian rowers Satnam Singh and Salman Khan pose with their bronze medal in the Men's Double Sculls event at the Asian Games 2026

PTI

podium finishes, including one gold. This edition's performance equalled that of the year 1982, 1994 and 2002 editions.

The Indian pair stayed in second place until the 1,500m mark before slipping to third in the final 500m, clocking 6:13.25 at

the Nagaragawa International Regatta Course.

China's Yi Xudi and Yide Nie won the gold medal with a timing of 6:09.37, while Uzbekistan's Pavel Sorin and Mekhrojbek Mamatkulov claimed silver after clocking 6:10.49.

The Indian duo finished

THIS EDITION'S PERFORMANCE EQUALLED THAT OF THE YEAR 1982, 1994 AND 2002 EDITIONS

3.88 seconds behind the gold medallists. Prime Minister Narendra Modi lauded the duo after their bronze-winning feat at the games.

"A fine performance by Satnam Singh and Salman Khan in the Men's Double Sculls, earning India a well-deserved Bronze medal.

Their composure and coordination stood out. May this achievement inspire them to scale even greater heights in the years ahead," the prime minister tweeted. Satnam, who had won a bronze at the Hangzhou edition in the men's quadruple sculls, thus added another Asian Games medal to his collection.

News at a glance

India A collapse to 199 all out on day three

PUDUCHERRY: Skipper Devdutt Padikkal struck a fifty and first-innings centurion Kumar Kushagra remained unbeaten on 46 as India A set Australia A an improbable target of 363 on day three of their opening four-day game here on Thursday.

India A were all out 199 in their second innings despite being 93 for one at one stage. Off-spinner Todd Murphy was the pick of the bowlers for the visitors taking four wickets including Sai Sudharshan's. The left-hander is eyeing a reserve opener's slot in the Indian team after being overtaken by Devdutt Padikkal for the number three spot.

Ukraine reaches second straight BJK Cup semifinal

SHENZHEN: Ukraine recovered from an upset to beat Belgium 2-1 on Thursday and reach the Billie Jean King Cup semifinals for the second straight season.

Doubles pair Anhelina Kalinina and Lyudmyla Kichenok comfortably beat Magali Kempen and Lara Salden 6-3, 6-3.

Earlier, seventh-ranked Elina Svitolina was upset by Greet Minnen. Svitolina won the first set 7-6 (5) but Minnen, ranked 217th, came back 6-4, 6-4 in the final two sets to send the series to a deciding doubles match.

Anantjeet-Parinaaz clinch skeet mixed-team bronze

NAGOYA: Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Parinaaz Dhaliwal gave Indian skeet another reason to celebrate on Thursday, shooting their way to a historic bronze — India's first-ever Asian Games medal in the mixed team event — after overcoming a nerve-racking final made even trickier by gusty winds.

The bronze completed a remarkable three-medal burst for Indian skeet in just two days, an unprecedented haul for a discipline that has long lived in the shadow of trap and double trap. It also brought some much-needed cheer to the shooting contingent.



Indian soft tennis athlete Jay Meena being welcomed upon his arrival at the Indira Gandhi International Airport in New Delhi

PTI

'I do what the script demands'

Ayushmann Khurrana on playing a Pakistan agent in 'Udta Teer'

Ayushmann Khurrana said he had no hesitation in playing a Pakistan agent in his upcoming spy comedy, 'Udta Teer', where he surrendered himself to the script and the director.

The film, directed by debutante director Akash A Kaushik, revolves around a Pakistani spy named Bilal Ahmad (Khurrana), who enters India and suffers from memory loss after an accident and mistakenly believes he is an Indian spy.

"It was part of the script (referring to the 'Pakistan zindabad' dialogue). As an actor, you are ready to do anything. This is a spy comedy. It's a patriotic comedy; it's a genre bender. I do what the script demands; I'm a director's baby. It is a fantastic script," Khurrana told reporters at the trailer launch of 'Udta Teer'.

The actor credited the director for developing a unique story like 'Udta Teer', which he described as India's first patriotic comedy film. "You must have watched spy films and they have their own take. But we haven't seen a film like this ('Udta Teer')



HE PAID TRIBUTE TO THE LATE MUKUL DEV, WHOM HE BELIEVES WAS 'UNDERUTILISED' BY THE FILM INDUSTRY

and this story is Akash's brainchild," he said.

Khurrana, known for films like 'Thamma', 'Article 15', 'Andhadhun', 'Vicky Donor' and others, said he has always been a 'risk-taker' and has often experimented with different genres and subjects. "It's the most difficult character because things were happening around him. I had to have that straight face; though there were

moments when I felt like laughing, I couldn't. I had to be normal while there was chaos happening around me," he added.

The movie boasts of an ensemble cast including Sara Ali Khan, Rahul Bose, Ram Kapoor, Suhail Nayyar, Gulshan Grover, Raghubir Yadav, Supriya Pilgaonkar, Smita Tambe and the late Mukul Dev.

Khurrana paid tribute to Dev, whom he believes was 'underutilised' by the film industry. PTI



We choose wrong films: Anurag

Kashyap said 'politics' messes up India's Oscar selection

Marathi film 'Gondhal', announced as India's submission for the upcoming Oscars, has joined the ranks of 'Homeland', 'Laapataa Ladies' and others previously submitted. Although none of the films since 2001's 'Lagaan' have made the shortlist for 'Best International Feature Film', India has consistently tried to make its submission count. In a recent interview, filmmaker Anurag Kashyap was asked why India never wins an Oscar and the director bluntly said, "Because we select absolutely wrong films." He specified that he's yet to watch 'Gondhal'.

In a chat with 'Variety India', Anurag said that even when India had the chance to select 'right' films like 'The Lunchbox' or 'All We Imagine As Light', the Film Federation of India 'messed it up'. He also alleged that both the aforementioned films were 'deliberately' not chosen by the FFI. When asked if the selection process was affected because of 'too much politics', the director said yes and added that there was a 'lack of awareness'. He shared, "This year, the competition is really tough. It's hard this year to beat the



'IT'S HARD THIS YEAR TO BEAT THE INTERNATIONAL ENTRIES FOR THE OSCARS,' HE SAYS

international entries for the Oscars."

Anurag also discussed the probable right path for a film to get noticed on an international stage and said, "The most important qualification for eligibility should be that the film should have gone to some international festival outside India or should have had American distribution or should have had an American distributor before year-end."

About 'Gondhal', he said that the film must try to get screened across various international festivals. AGENCIES

'Afroz is more of a listener'



OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video recently released its latest 'MX Original' series 'Waiting Hai' season one and among its ensemble of relatable characters, Bhuvan Arora's portrayal of Afroz stands out for its quiet, understated quality. A man of few words, Afroz often communicates through his expressions, reactions and presence, making restraint an important part of the character's performance.

Speaking about the process of bringing the character to life, Bhuvan shared, "Afroz is not really a talker; he's more of a listener, so there was a conscious choice not to make him speak too much. In fact, throughout the show, he has the least amount of dialogue and verbal communication and that became an important part of how we built his character."

FOOL VOLUME

Vir Das gets third International Emmy nomination

In another feather in his cap, actor-comedian Vir Das has earned his third Emmy nomination, with his latest stand-up special 'Vir Das: Fool Volume' bagging a nod at the International Emmy Awards. With this, he now holds the distinction of being the first Indian performer to receive three International Emmy nominations for his work.

Sharing the news on 'Instagram', Das expressed gratitude to his fans for their support as he wrote, "Ummmm. An International Emmy Nomination. Our third for India. This fool thanks you. #foolvolume." Congratulatory messages have been pouring in for the comedian, including the likes of Zoya Akhtar, Bhumi Pednekar, Sheeba Chadha and others.

His Emmy journey began in 2021, when his 'Vir Das: For India' received his first International



THE ACTOR-COMEDIAN BECAME THE FIRST INDIAN PERFORMER WITH THREE NODS

Emmy nomination in the Comedy category. Two years later, in 2023, Das returned to the nominations with 'Vir Das: Landing' and went on to win the International Emmy for comedy, becoming the first Indian comedian to win the honour.

With 'Fool Volume', Das now becomes a three-time International Emmy nominee, with all three nominations coming for his comedy specials.

"There's something wonderfully strange about being nominated for an International Emmy for a show called 'Fool Volume'," he said. AGENCIES

'WANTED TO BE PART OF BINGE-WATCHING CULTURE'



Netflix's 'Shaque' marks Parineeti Chopra's entry into the web series space

life. I don't think I could have done it because if I had, I would have cried in every scene. Then there would have been no performance. So, thank God, I didn't have a child in real life then," she said.

The crime-thriller show is directed by Rensil D'Silva, who also serves as the creator, along with Siddharth P Malhotra.

'Shaque' marks actor Parineeti Chopra's entry into the web series space, something that the actress said she wanted to do for a while. The 'Netflix' series will feature Chopra in the role of a mother in search of her missing child.

"I just wanted to do a series; it was just a new format for me that I hadn't explored. I had done reality shows and films; I wanted to do this new format, this series thing. I wanted to be part of the binge-watching culture," she told PTI.

Parineeti said she had been in talks with 'Netflix' for some time to find the right script. Counting 'Game of Thrones' and 'The Narcos' on 'Netflix' among her favourite shows. For 'Shaque', Chopra said she didn't draw from real life. The actress, who welcomed her son in October last year, said she discovered she was pregnant midway through the shoot of the show.

"I wasn't a mother then. At that time, I was purely acting, depending on the material and the director. I didn't draw anything out of real

Chopra credited filmmaker Imtiaz Ali's 'Amar Singh Chamkila' (2024) as a major milestone in her career. "I had many films that hadn't done well and people tend to forget about you or your work or talent, whatever you want to label it. I think 'Chamkila' just kind of awoke people again, makers again, towards me. And the kind of work that I started getting offered after that was really a testament to that. And you know what 'Chamkila' had done for me and even Diljit (Dosaanjh), for both of us, we've done amazing work after that. So, I'm thankful for a film like that in my life." PTI



SHE HAD BEEN IN TALKS WITH 'NETFLIX' FOR SOME TIME TO FIND THE RIGHT SCRIPT

Blood, bullets and Ranbir Kapoor in first look of 'Love & War'

The film also stars actors Alia Bhatt & Vicky Kaushal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Ranbir Kapoor's first look from Sanjay Leela Bhansali's much-awaited period drama 'Love & War' has arrived and it shows the actor driving a car with a bullet injury.

Released by 'Bhansali Productions' on Thursday, ahead of Ranbir's birthday, the first poster features the actor in a white shirt, seated inside a blue car, with his bloodied left hand hanging outside the window. The injury appears to have been caused by a bullet.

Directed by Sanjay Leela Bhansali, the film is billed as an epic saga set against the backdrop of war. It brings together Ranbir, Alia Bhatt and Vicky Kaushal in the lead roles, with Vicky making his first collaboration with Bhansali. The film releases on January 21, 2027.



THE FIRST LOOK SHOWS RANBIR DRIVING A CAR WITH A BULLET INJURY

For Ranbir, 'Love & War' marks a reunion with Bhansali nearly two decades after his acting debut in 'Saawariya' (2007), which also featured Sonam Kapoor. The actor is returning to the filmmaker

after 19 years. Alia has previously worked with Bhansali in 'Gangubai Kathiawadi' (2022), which went on to win the National Award for 'Best Actress' for her performance.

Ranbir, meanwhile, has a packed line-up ahead. He will next headline Nitesh Tiwari's ambitious 'Ramayana', which is planned as a two-part release during Diwali 2026 and Diwali 2027. He will also return as Ranvijay Singh in 'Animal Park', the sequel to Sandeep Reddy Vanga's 'Animal'.

Vicky Kaushal, who was last seen in Laxman Utekar's historical biopic 'Chhaava', is now set to share screen space with Ranbir and Alia in Bhansali's much-anticipated period drama.